A DAWAH MASTER BOOK FOR CHINA

认识真主

Knowing the Creator

স্রষ্টাকে জানা

Evidence, answers and conversation
with Chinese from HSK 1 to HSK 4
给中国朋友的证据与对话

中文 · English · বাংলা · **HSK 1–4**

VOLUME 1 · DAWAH & EVIDENCE
প্রথম খণ্ড · দাওয়াহ ও প্রমাণ

Mohammad Israfil Hossain

FIRST WORKING EDITION · 2026

Knowing the Creator 认识真主

Volume 1 of 2: Dawah and Evidence · 给中国朋友的证据与对话

Mohammad Israfil Hossain

First working edition, October 2026

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About this volume

This is **Volume 1 of 2: Dawah & Evidence**. It holds Parts I–IV (the dawah handbook, the evidence library, the objections bank and the China context) and Appendix B (sources, indexes and glossary). **Volume 2: Chinese & Practice** holds Part V (Chinese course), Part VI (Practice Ladder) and Appendices A and C (vocabulary and the full HSK 1–4 word list). References in this volume to Parts V–VI and Appendices A and C point to Volume 2.

> এটা প্রথম খণ্ড: দাওয়াহ ও প্রমাণ। চাইনিজ কোর্স, Practice Ladder আর শব্দতালিকা আছে দ্বিতীয় খণ্ডে। দুই খণ্ড একসাথে সম্পূর্ণ বই (Complete edition) হিসেবেও পাওয়া যায়।

The complete edition, both volumes and audio for every Chinese word and sentence: https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/

Preface

This book was written for a Muslim living in China who wants to answer two kinds of questions: the questions of people who do not believe in God, and the questions Chinese people ask about Islam. It was also written for someone still learning Chinese, so the language is taught alongside the message.

Three convictions shaped it. First, truth does not need exaggeration: every piece of evidence in this book is graded, and claims that careful Muslim scholars themselves reject have been left out or marked. Second, character comes before argument: most people are moved by a trustworthy friend long before they are moved by a proof. Third, China is not foreign soil for Islam: Muslims have lived here since 651, and Chinese Muslim scholars explained Islam in the language of Confucius more than three centuries ago. This book follows their path.

It is a working edition. Before you print or teach from it, ask a qualified scholar to review the religious content and a native Chinese speaker to review the Chinese (see the pre-publication checklist in Appendix B).

How to use this book: a 12-week plan

কোথা থেকে শুরু করবে? তোমার চাইনিজ যদি HSK 1–3 হয়, প্রথমে **Part VI**-এর ১২ সপ্তাহের roadmap (VI.12) অনুসরণ করো: প্রতিদিন ২০ মিনিট। Part VI-এর Stage 3 শেষ হলে নিচের ১২ সপ্তাহের পরিকল্পনায় যাও, যেখানে Part V-এর পাঠ আর Part I-এর যুক্তি একসাথে চলে। **Where to start:** at HSK 1–3, follow the Part VI roadmap first (VI.12, 20 minutes a day). When you finish Stage 3, move to the plan below.

Tone colours. In the Word and print edition every pinyin syllable is coloured by its tone. Learn the five colours once and you will "see" the tone of every new word.

Tone	Pinyin	汉字	Meaning	How it sounds
1st	mā	妈	mother	high and flat
2nd	má	麻	hemp	rising, like a question
3rd	mǎ	马	horse	low, dips, then rises
4th	mà	骂	to scold	falls sharply
Neutral	ma	吗	question word	short and light

টোনের রং: লাল = ১ম টোন, সবুজ = ২য়, নীল = ৩য়, বেগুনি = ৪র্থ, ধূসর = হালকা (neutral) টোন।

Audio companion. Every Chinese word and sentence in this book can be heard on your phone: scan the QR code, tap ▶️, and use 🐢 *Slow* and 🙈 *Hide* to practise. The page uses your phone's built-in Chinese voice, the same way your HSK app does.

https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/

অডিও: QR কোড স্ক্যান করো, প্রতিটা বাক্যের পাশে ▶ চাপো। ফোনে চাইনিজ ভয়েস না থাকলে Settings থেকে Chinese (Mandarin) ভয়েস ইনস্টল করো।

Each week pairs one Chinese lesson with the dawah content it teaches you to say. Daily: 30 minutes of Chinese (Part V) and 10 minutes of reading. Weekly: one visit to the mosque or the ahong, and one real conversation.

Week	Chinese lesson (Part V)	Read in Part I	Go deeper	Practice this week
1	1. Introducing yourself	Chapter 1	Part IV, sections 1 and 4	Introduce yourself to three people
2	2. Asking what people believe	Chapter 7, section 7.1	Part IV, section 3	Ask three friends 你有宗教信仰吗？
3	3. The universe had a beginning	Chapter 2.1; Chapter 3, Q1 and Q4	Part III, A1-A3	Explain the origin argument once
4	4. Design, not coincidence	Chapter 2.2-2.3	Part III, A4-A5	Use the watch example
5	5. One God, no idols	Chapter 4.1; Chapter 5.7	Part IV, section 5	Visit a mosque with a friend

Week	Chinese lesson (Part V)	Read in Part I	Go deeper	Practice this week
6	6. Science and Islam	Chapter 3, Q2-Q3; Chapter 4.3	Part II, sections 2-3	Learn two grade-A examples in Chinese
7	7. Purpose and the afterlife	Chapter 3, Q16	Part III, B9-B10	Ask 然后呢？ gently
8	8. Suffering, free will, justice	Chapter 3, Q6, Q13, Q14	Part III, B1-B8	Answer the suffering question calmly
9	9. Pork, prayer, hijab, Ramadan	Chapter 5.2-5.5	Part III, F1 and F4	Invite a colleague to a halal meal
10	10. Family and Confucian bridges	Chapter 5.6; Chapter 6.2	Part IV, section 2	Quote Confucius and the hadith together
11	11. Agreeing and disagreeing	Chapter 3, Q7-Q11	Part III, E1-E7	Role-play three objections with a friend
12	12. The one-minute message	Chapter 7.4; Chapter 8	Part II, sections 4-7	Give the one-minute message from memory

After week 12, repeat the cycle, this time reading the Chinese lines in Part I without the pinyin. When you can, you are at HSK 4 reading level for this subject.

Sources, evidence grades and abbreviations

Citation style. Numbers in square brackets, like [3], point to the numbered notes at the end of each chapter of Part I. Parts II, III and IV give their sources beside each item and in a Sources section at the end. Appendix B collects every source in one bibliography.

Quran references are written surah:verse, so 52:35 means Surah 52, verse 35. English meanings follow Sahih International in simplified form; Chinese follows Ma Jian's translation. Lines marked * are close renderings of the meaning that must be checked against a printed Ma Jian Quran.

Hadith references give the collection and the number used on sunnah.com, with the grade where it matters:

Grade	Meaning	Use
Sahih 健全	Authentic	Quote freely
Hasan 良好	Good	Quote freely
Da'if 脆弱	Weak	Do not attribute to the Prophet
Mawdu' 伪造	Fabricated	Never quote

Evidence grades (Part II): **A** = plain Arabic, use freely; **B** = reasonable but interpretive, present as a possible reading; **C** = depends on one translation or is disputed, avoid with sceptics. **Verification labels: S** = confirmed through a quoted extract of the source page; **K** = standard content of the named book, not re-confirmed; **Unverified** = could not be traced; **Drop** = rejected by careful scholars or shown false.

How the research was done. The sources were collected on 27 October 2026 from the free dawah literature, academic publications and survey organisations. The research tools could search the web but could not open the pages in full, so each source was confirmed through the search engine's quoted extract. Open each link and check the wording before you cite it publicly.

Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
CE	Common Era (the same years as AD)
HSK	汉语水平考试, the Chinese proficiency test, levels 1-6; D = dawah word outside the HSK lists
BSOAS	*Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies*
CGSS / CFPS	China General Social Survey / China Family Panel Studies
NRAA	National Religious Affairs Administration (国家宗教事务局)
Pew	Pew Research Center, Washington DC

Disclaimer, legal note and scholarly review

- **Not a fatwa.** This book summarises what established Muslim scholars and institutions have written; it is not a ruling. On any question of belief or practice, follow a qualified scholar.
- **Not legal advice.** Part I, Chapter 1 and Part IV, section 4 summarise the published rules on foreigners' religious activity in China as of October 2026. Rules and their enforcement change; check them yourself. This book is for your own study. Do not copy, print or distribute it to Chinese citizens, and do not post its content on Chinese platforms.
- **Chinese language.** The Chinese was prepared for a learner and has not yet been checked by a native speaker. Have a Chinese Muslim or teacher correct it before you rely on it in public.
- **Quran and hadith.** Check every Chinese verse against Ma Jian's printed translation and every hadith number at sunnah.com before quoting.
- **Humility.** If anything in this book is correct, it is from God; any error is from its compilers. Corrections are welcome and will be added to the next edition.

Part I: The Dawah Handbook

Part I is the book you speak from. Each chapter gives the answer in English so you understand it fully, then a short Chinese version with pinyin that you can say aloud or show on your phone. Numbers in square brackets, like [1], point to the notes at the end of each chapter, where the evidence and sources are listed. The full evidence is in Part II, the full set of objections in Part III, the Chinese background in Part IV, and the language lessons in Part V.

Chapter 1: Dawah in China: method, manners and the law



🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s01

1.1 Who you are speaking to

Most Chinese people are not committed atheists. About 10% of Chinese adults formally identify with a religion, yet 47% believe in fengshui and 33% believe in the Buddha or a bodhisattva [1]. Many were taught atheism at school but still speak of fate (命 mìng), Heaven (天 tiān) and ancestors. Most have never thought seriously about God. Your first task is rarely to defeat atheism; it is to help someone think about the question for the first time.

Confucian values (honesty, respect for parents, modesty, family, self-discipline) are close to Islamic values, and Chinese Muslim scholars used them as a bridge 350 years ago [2]. Islam has been in China since 651 CE [3]. You are not bringing something foreign; you are pointing to something already part of China's story.

1.2 The law: what you may and may not do

Two sets of rules apply to you as a foreigner: the Regulations on Religious Affairs (in force since 1 February 2018) and the Detailed Rules on the religious activities of foreigners (National Religious Affairs Administration Order No. 23, in force since 1 May 2025) [4].

- **You may** attend a registered mosque, join foreigner-only gatherings at approved venues, bring a few religious books for personal use, and live your faith openly.
- **You may not** preach without authorisation, recruit Chinese citizens as followers, distribute or sell religious materials, set up any religious group or class, or post religious content online for Chinese audiences.

In practice: build friendships, answer questions people ask you, and when someone is seriously interested, introduce them to the ahong (imam) at a registered mosque. Never discuss Xinjiang or politics. Protect yourself and the people you talk to. Part IV, section 4 gives the details.

1.3 The method of the Quran

“Invite to the way of your Lord with wisdom and good instruction, and argue with them in a way that is best” (Quran 16:125). In practice:

1. **Friendship first.** Share food (halal food is a natural topic), help people, be reliable. Chinese culture trusts people before arguments.
2. **Ask questions, do not lecture.** “Do you think the universe has a beginning?” works better than a speech.

3. **Agree where you can.** “Yes, science is important. Islam commands us to study it.” Then add the one point they are missing.
4. **One idea per conversation.** Leave them with one thing to think about, not twenty.
5. **Respect Chinese civilisation.** Never mock the Buddha, Confucius or China. Quote Confucius correctly and you earn respect immediately [2].
6. **Admit what you do not know.** “Good question, let me find the answer” builds more trust than a weak answer.
7. **Use only evidence that survives checking.** A Chinese student with a phone will check your claim in thirty seconds. Part II grades every piece of evidence; use the strong ones [5].
8. **Guidance is from God.** “You cannot guide whom you love, but God guides whom He wills” (Quran 28:56). Your duty is to deliver the message clearly and kindly; results are not your responsibility.

1.4 Key sentence

我不是想说服你，我只是想和你一起思考这个问题。

Wǒ bú shì xiǎng shuōfú nǐ, wǒ zhǐ shì xiǎng hé nǐ yìqǐ sīkǎo zhège wèntí.

“I am not trying to convince you; I just want to think about this question together with you.”

Notes and evidence for Chapter 1

1. Pew Research Center, *Measuring Religion in China*, 30 August 2023, using the China General Social Survey 2018 and the China Family Panel Studies 2018. pewresearch.org. Details in Part IV, section 3.
2. Confucius, *Analects* 6.22 (敬鬼神而远之) and 15.24 (己所不欲，勿施于人). On the Han Kitab scholars Wang Daiyu, Ma Zhu and Liu Zhi: Sachiko Murata, William Chittick and Tu Weiming, *The Sage Learning of Liu Zhi* (Harvard, 2009); James Frankel, *Rectifying God's Name* (University of Hawaii Press, 2011). Part IV, section 2.
3. *Old Book of Tang* (旧唐书), recording the Arab embassy of 651 CE (永徽二年). Part IV, section 1.
4. Regulations on Religious Affairs (宗教事务条例), revised 2017, in force 1 February 2018, bilingual text at CECC; Detailed Rules for the Implementation of the Provisions on the Administration of Religious Activities of Foreigners, NRAA Order No. 23, in force 1 May 2025, China Law Translate. This is a summary, not legal advice.
5. Yaqeen Institute, Hatem al-Haj, “In Defense of Faith: Principles and Guidelines for Islamic Apologetics”, yaqeeninstitute.org.

Chapter 2: Why believe in God: six arguments

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s02

You do not need all six. Learn the first two deeply; they are enough for most conversations. The others are for people who push further. The Chinese course teaches these in Lessons 3 and 4.

2.1 The universe began, so it needs a cause

- Everything that begins to exist has a cause. Nothing comes from nothing.
- The universe began to exist. Modern cosmology places the beginning of space, time and matter about 13.8 billion years ago, and the Borde-Guth-Vilenkin theorem shows that any universe that has on average been expanding cannot be infinite in the past [1].

- Therefore the universe has a cause. That cause is outside space, time and matter: timeless, non-physical, immensely powerful, and it chose to create, because a timeless cause producing a universe that begins in time implies a will. This is what we call God.
- Quran 52:35-36: “Were they created by nothing, or were they the creators? Or did they create the heavens and the earth? No, they have no certainty.” The three options (from nothing, self-created, created by a Creator) are the whole debate in two verses [2].

中文: 宇宙有开始。有开始的东西一定有原因。所以宇宙有一个超越时间和空间的创造者。(Yǔzhòu yǒu kāishǐ. Yǒu kāishǐ de dōngxi yídìng yǒu yuányīn. Suǒyǐ yǔzhòu yǒu yí ge chāoyuè shíjiān hé kōngjiān de chuàngzàozhě.) “The universe had a beginning. Whatever begins must have a cause. So the universe has a Creator beyond time and space.”

2.2 The universe is fine-tuned for life

- The constants of physics sit inside very narrow ranges. The cosmological constant is often described as tuned to about one part in 10^120; a small change in the strength of the strong nuclear force would prevent the formation of carbon or of stable atoms [3].
- There are three explanations: chance, necessity or design. Chance of this size is not a serious answer. Physics does not say the constants had to have these values. Design is the natural reading.
- The multiverse is the usual escape, but it is unobserved, and a universe-generator would itself need fine-tuning, which moves the problem up one level [4].
- Quran 67:3: “You do not see in the creation of the Most Merciful any inconsistency. So return your vision to the sky: do you see any flaw?”

中文: 物理常数非常精确，稍微改变一点，生命就不可能存在。这不像巧合，更像设计。(Wùlǐ chángshù fēicháng jīngquè, shāowēi gǎibiàn yìdiǎn, shēngmìng jiù bù kěnéng cúnzài. Zhè bú xiàng qiǎohé, gèng xiàng shèjì.) “The physical constants are extremely precise. Change them slightly and life is impossible. This does not look like coincidence; it looks like design.”

2.3 Information and order in life

- DNA is a code: four chemical letters, about three billion of them in the human genome, read by molecular machines with error correction [5]. Every code whose origin we know comes from a mind.
- Evolution, even if fully true, explains how life changes, not how the first self-copying life or the laws that allow it began. The origin of life remains an open problem in science [6].
- The Quran commands reflection on creation as a path to faith (3:190-191) and describes the stages of the embryo (23:12-14).

中文: DNA 是一种密码。我们知道来源的所有密码都来自智慧。(DNA shì yì zhǒng mìmǎ. Wǒmen zhīdào láiyuán de suǒyǒu mìmǎ dōu láizì zhìhuì.) “DNA is a code. Every code whose source we know comes from intelligence.”

2.4 Objective morality needs a Lawgiver

- Almost everyone agrees that torturing a child for fun is really wrong, not just unfashionable. That is an objective moral fact.
- Without God, morality is only chemistry, culture or a survival strategy. Then “wrong” means “most people dislike it”, and a society that decides otherwise is not actually wrong.
- Objective moral duties make sense if there is a Lawgiver above all humans. Atheists can be good people; the point is that atheism cannot explain why goodness is binding [7].
- Chinese bridge: Mencius taught that humans are born with a good conscience (良心 liángxīn) and innate moral knowledge (良知 liángzhī) [8]. Islam calls this the fitrah, the nature God placed in every person (Quran 30:30).

中文: 如果没有真主，善恶只是个人意见。但我们都知道，有些事是真正的错。(Rúguǒ méiyǒu Zhēnzhǔ, shàn'è zhǐ shì gèrén yìjiàn. Dàn wǒmen dōu zhīdào, yǒu xiē shì shì zhēnzhèng de cuò.) “If there is no God, good and evil are only opinion. But we all know some things are truly wrong.”

2.5 Consciousness and reason

- Atoms do not think, feel or understand. No physical description captures what it is like to experience something; philosophers call this the hard problem of consciousness [9].
- If the mind were only atoms moved by physical laws, your beliefs, including atheism, would be the result of chemistry, not reasoning. Why trust them? A self that understands truth points beyond matter. Islam teaches that the soul is from God's command (Quran 17:85).

中文: 原子不会思考。为什么你会？(Yuánzǐ bú huì sīkǎo. Wèishénme nǐ huì?) “Atoms cannot think. Why can you?”

2.6 The fitrah: belief is natural, atheism is learned

- Children across cultures naturally see purpose and a maker behind the world; psychologists have described them as “intuitive theists” [10]. Almost every civilisation in history believed in a higher power. Atheism must be taught.
- The Prophet said: “Every child is born upon the fitrah” [11]. In danger, even people who deny God call on Him (Quran 10:22, 29:65).
- Chinese people say 谢天谢地 (“thank heaven and earth”) and 老天爷 (“Old Heavenly Lord”). This is the fitrah speaking through the language.

中文: 你们说“老天爷”、“谢天谢地”。你们的心其实已经知道有一个更高的主宰。(Nǐmen shuō “Lǎotiānyé”, “xiè tiān xiè dì”. Nǐmen de xīn qíshí yǐjīng zhīdào yǒu yí ge gèng gāo de zhǔzǎi.) “You say ‘Old Heavenly Lord’ and ‘thank heaven and earth’. Your heart already knows there is a higher Master.”

Notes and evidence for Chapter 2

1. Arvind Borde, Alan Guth and Alexander Vilenkin, “Inflationary spacetimes are incomplete in past directions”, *Physical Review Letters* 90, 151301 (2003). Age of the universe: Planck Collaboration, *Planck 2018 results VI: Cosmological parameters*, Astronomy & Astrophysics 641, A6 (2020).
2. Hamza Tzortzis, “The Qur'an's Argument for God's Existence”, hamzatzortzis.com; Ibn Kathir, tafsir of 52:35, quran.com.
3. Luke Barnes and Geraint Lewis, *A Fortunate Universe: Life in a Finely Tuned Cosmos* (Cambridge University Press, 2016); Martin Rees, *Just Six Numbers* (1999). Exact figures vary between authors; say “extremely narrow” rather than quoting one number as certain.
4. Imam Mufti, “Fine-Tuning of the Universe”, parts 5-8, islamreligion.com.
5. International Human Genome Sequencing Consortium, “Finishing the euchromatic sequence of the human genome”, *Nature* 431 (2004).
6. Yaqeen Institute, Nazir Khan and Yasir Qadhi, “Human Origins, Part 2: Evolution and the Failures of Naturalism”, yaqeeninstitute.org.
7. Hamza Tzortzis, “Know God, Know Good”, hamzatzortzis.com.
8. *Mencius* 6A8 (良心) and 7A15 (良知). Comparative study: “Liangzhi and Fitrah”, *Comparative Philosophy* 16(2), 2025, scholarworks.sjsu.edu.
9. David Chalmers, “Facing Up to the Problem of Consciousness”, *Journal of Consciousness Studies* 2(3), 1995.
10. Deborah Kelemen, “Are Children ‘Intuitive Theists’?”, *Psychological Science* 15(5), 2004; Justin Barrett, *Born Believers: The Science of Children's Religious Belief* (Free Press, 2012).
11. Sahih al-Bukhari 1385; Sahih Muslim 2658 (narrated by Abu Hurayrah).

Chapter 3: Sixteen questions atheists ask

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s03

Each answer gives the English explanation, then a short Chinese reply you can say. Part III has 45 objections in more depth.

Q1. "If everything needs a cause, who created God?" 谁创造了真主？

The argument never said "everything needs a cause". It said "everything that **begins** needs a cause". God does not begin; He is eternal and outside time. Asking "who created the uncreated?" is like asking "what is north of the North Pole?". An endless chain of creators is impossible too: if every creator needed a creator, nothing would ever start, like a line of soldiers each waiting for the one behind to fire first. The chain must end in one uncreated Creator [1]. Quran 112:3: "He neither begets nor is born."

中文: 我们说的是"有开始的东西需要原因"。真主没有开始，他是永恒的，在时间之外。如果每个创造者都需要创造者，那什么都不会存在。(Wǒmen shuō de shì "yǒu kāishǐ de dōngxi xūyào yuányīn". Zhēnzhǔ méiyǒu kāishǐ, tā shì yǒnghéng de, zài shíjiān zhī wài. Rúguǒ měi ge chuàngzàozhě dōu xūyào chuàngzàozhě, nà shénme dōu bú huì cúnzài.)

Q2. "Science explains everything. Religion is unscientific." 科学能解释一切

Science explains **how** things work inside the universe. It cannot explain why the universe exists, why its laws exist, why mathematics describes it, or what is right and wrong. "Only science gives knowledge" is itself not a scientific statement; no experiment proves it. Islam has no conflict with science: the first word revealed was "Read" (96:1). Ibn al-Haytham's *Book of Optics* (c. 1011-1021) used systematic experiment centuries before Europe; the word "algebra" comes from al-Khwarizmi's book *al-Jabr* (c. 820); Ibn Sina's *Canon of Medicine* was taught in European universities for 500 years [2]. Many scientists believe in God, including Francis Collins, who led the Human Genome Project [3].

中文: 科学解释宇宙怎么运行，但不能解释宇宙为什么存在。伊斯兰鼓励科学，《古兰经》的第一个字是"诵读"。"代数"这个词就来自穆斯林科学家。(Kēxué jiěshì yǔzhòu zěnme yùnxíng, dàn bù néng jiěshì yǔzhòu wèishénme cúnzài. Yīsīlán gǔlì kēxué, 《Gǔlánjīng》 de dì-yī ge zì shì "sòngdú". "Dàishù" zhège cí jiù láizì Mùsīlín kēxuéjiā.)

Q3. "Evolution proves there is no God." 进化论证明没有神

Evolution, even if accepted completely, describes a process. A process needs laws, a starting point and a universe that allows it. It does not explain where the first life, the laws or the universe came from. Natural selection is not a creator; it only removes what fails. Muslim scholars hold that nothing in scripture denies common ancestry for other life; Adam's special creation is a claim about one lineage that science, which studies regularities, cannot rule out [4]. The real question is whether the whole system (universe, laws and life) is an accident or a creation.

中文: 就算进化论完全正确，它也只是一个过程。过程需要规律和起点。进化论不能解释第一个生命从哪里来，也不能解释宇宙从哪里来。(Jiùsuàn jìnhuàlùn wánquán zhèngquè, tā yě zhǐ shì yí ge guòchéng. Guòchéng xūyào guīlǜ hé qǐdiǎn. Jìnhuàlùn bù néng jiěshì dì-yī ge shēngmìng cóng nǎlǐ lái, yě bù néng jiěshì yǔzhòu cóng nǎlǐ lái.)

Q4. “The Big Bang created everything. No God needed.” 宇宙大爆炸创造了一切

The Big Bang is evidence for a beginning, which supports a Creator. Before it was accepted in the 1960s, many atheists preferred an eternal universe. An explosion is an event, not a cause: what caused it? And the “nothing” of popular physics books, the quantum vacuum, is not nothing; it is a field with laws and energy that itself needs explaining [5]. Quran 21:30: “Do the disbelievers not see that the heavens and the earth were a joined entity, and We separated them?”

中文: 大爆炸是一个事件，不是一个原因。是什么引起了大爆炸？大爆炸说明宇宙有开始，这正是有创造者的证据。(Dàbàozhà shì yí ge shìjiàn, bú shì yí ge yuányīn. Shì shénme yǐnqǐ le dàbàozhà? Dàbàozhà shuōmíng yǔzhòu yǒu kāishǐ, zhè zhèng shì yǒu chuàngzàozhě de zhèngjù.)

Q5. “I cannot see God, so there is no evidence.” 我看不见真主

You cannot see gravity, electrons, the past, your own mind or your parents' love. You know them from their effects. We know the Creator from His effects: the universe, its order, its laws, our conscience. A watch proves a watchmaker even if you never meet him. The Quran praises those who “believe in the unseen” (2:3) on the basis of signs, not blind faith. And if God were a visible object inside the universe, He would be part of creation, not the Creator.

中文: 你也看不见引力、看不见电子、看不见你自己的思想，但你相信它们存在，因为你看到了它们的作用。我们通过创造认识创造者。(Nǐ yě kàn bú jiàn yǐnlì, kàn bú jiàn diànzǐ, kàn bú jiàn nǐ zìjǐ de sīxiǎng, dàn nǐ xiāngxìn tāmen cúnzài, yīnwèi nǐ kàndào le tāmen de zuòyòng. Wǒmen tōngguò chuàngzào rènshi chuàngzàozhě.)

Q6. “If God is good and powerful, why is there suffering?” 为什么有痛苦？

This is the most emotional question, so answer gently [6]:

1. Suffering disproves God only if God could have no good reason to allow it. A limited human cannot see all reasons, just as a child cannot understand why a doctor gives an injection.
2. This life is a test, not paradise (Quran 67:2). Free will means people can choose evil, and most suffering comes from human choices: war, greed, oppression. Remove free will and you remove love, courage and every virtue.
3. Suffering produces patience, compassion and humility. The Prophet said no hardship, illness or sorrow befalls a believer without God removing some of his sins by it [7].
4. Islam promises perfect justice in the next life: every wrong repaid, every pain compensated (Quran 99:7-8). Atheism has no answer at all: the victim simply dies and the oppressor wins.

中文: 这个世界是考验，不是天堂。大部分痛苦来自人的选择。如果没有真主，受害者永远得不到公正。伊斯兰说，每一个不公都会在后世得到公正。(Zhège shìjiè shì kǎoyàn, bú shì tiāntáng. Dàbùfen tòngkǔ láizì rén de xuǎnzé. Rúguǒ méiyǒu Zhēnzhǔ, shòuhàizhě yǒngyuǎn dé bú dào gōngzhèng. Yīsīlán shuō, měi yí ge bùgōng dōu huì zài hòushì dédào gōngzhèng.)

Q7. “Religion causes war and hatred.” 宗教引起战争

The *Encyclopedia of Wars* lists 1,763 wars in history and classes 123 of them, about 7%, as religious [8]. The deadliest century was the 20th, dominated by secular ideologies [9]. People fight over land, power and money and sometimes use religion as a flag. Islam forbids killing innocents (5:32: killing one innocent is like killing all mankind), forbids forced conversion (2:256), and commands justice even toward enemies (5:8). Judge Islam by its texts, not by people who break them.

In China, make the general point (ideologies have killed more than religions) and move on. Do not criticise the Chinese state.

中文: 历史上只有大约百分之七的战争是因为宗教。人为了土地、权力和钱而战争。《古兰经》说：杀一个无辜的人，就像杀了全人类。(Lìshǐ shang zhǐ yǒu dàyuē bǎi fēn zhī qī de zhànzhēng shì yīnwèi zōngjiào. Rén wèi le tǔdì, quánlì hé qián ér zhànzhēng. 《Gǔlánjīng》 shuō: shā yí ge wúgū de rén, jiù xiàng shā le quán rénlèi.)

Q8. "I can be a good person without religion." 没有宗教我也可以是好人

Agree warmly: yes, you can, because God gave every human a conscience. But two questions follow. First, why be good when nobody is watching and being bad would benefit you? Atheism has no answer except personal taste. Second, who defines "good"? Societies have disagreed (slavery was once called good); without a standard above humans, "good" changes with fashion [10]. And being good is not the whole purpose of life. The purpose is to know and thank the One who gave you life.

中文: 是的，你可以是好人，因为真主给了每个人良心。但是，谁来定义"好"？还有，人生的目的不只是做好人，还要认识和感谢给你生命的那一位。(Shì de, nǐ kěyǐ shì hǎorén, yīnwèi Zhēnzhǔ gěi le měi ge rén liángxīn. Dànshì, shéi lái dìngyì "hǎo"? Háiyǒu, rénshēng de mùdì bù zhǐ shì zuò hǎorén, hái yào rènshi hé gǎnxiè gěi nǐ shēngmìng de nà yí wèi.)

Q9. "There are thousands of religions. They cannot all be right." 那么多宗教，哪个是对的？

Many answers do not mean no answer is right; a maths problem has many wrong answers and one right one. Most religions agree on the core: a higher power, a purpose, a judgement. Islam's position is that God sent the same message to every people ("there was no nation but a warner passed among them", 35:24; also 16:36), people changed it over time, and the Quran is the final, preserved version. So the question is not "which of 4,000 religions?" but "which message about the One God is still unchanged?"

中文: 有很多答案，不等于没有正确答案。数学题有很多错的答案，但只有一个对的。伊斯兰说，真主给每个民族都派过使者，传的是同一个信息。(Yǒu hěn duō dá'àn, bù děngyú méiyǒu zhèngquè dá'àn. Shùxué tí yǒu hěn duō cuò de dá'àn, dàn zhǐ yǒu yí ge duì de. Yīsīlán shuō, Zhēnzhǔ gěi měi ge mínzú dōu pài guò shǐzhě, chuán de shì tóng yí ge xìnxī.)

Q10. "You only believe because you were born into it." 你信教只是因为你生在那里

This is the genetic fallacy: where a belief came from says nothing about whether it is true. A Chinese atheist believes what Chinese schools taught; that does not make atheism true or false either. People also enter Islam as adults from every background, including former atheists and scientists (Part II, section 8). Turn it into a question: "Have you examined what you were taught?"

中文: 你不信教，也是因为你生在中国，学校这样教你。一个信念从哪里来，和它对不对是两件事。重要的是：你有没有自己认真想过？(Nǐ bú xìnjiào, yě shì yīnwèi nǐ shēng zài Zhōngguó, xuéxiào zhèyàng jiāo nǐ. Yí ge xìnniàn cóng nǎlǐ lái, hé tā duì bú duì shì liǎng jiàn shì. Zhòngyào de shì: nǐ yǒu méiyǒu zìjǐ rènzhēn xiǎng guo?)

Q11. "Religion is the opium of the people, for the weak and uneducated." 宗教是人民的鸦片

Marx's line (1844) is a sociological opinion, not an argument about whether God exists; the same sentence calls religion "the sigh of the oppressed creature" [11]. The Quran commands knowledge: "Are those who know equal to those who do not know?" (39:9). The University of al-Qarawiyyin in Fez, founded by a Muslim woman, Fatima al-Fihri, in 859, is recognised as the oldest existing, continually operating degree-granting institution in the world [12]. Comfort is not the test of truth, and the charge reverses: believing there will be no judgement is very

comforting for someone who wants to do as he likes. Religion is not a crutch but a map: where you came from and where you are going.

中文: 《古兰经》说："有知识的人和没有知识的人能相等吗？"世界上至今还在办学的最古老的大学，是一位穆斯林女性创办的。宗教不是拐杖，是地图：告诉你从哪里来，到哪里去。(《Gǔlánjīng》 shuō: "Yǒu zhīshi de rén hé méiyǒu zhīshi de rén néng xiāngděng ma?" Shìjiè shang zhìjīn hái zài bànxué de zuì gǔlǎo de dàxué, shì yí wèi Mùsīlín nǚxìng chuàngbàn de. Zōngjiào bú shì guǎizhàng, shì dìtú: gàosu nǐ cóng nǎlǐ lái, dào nǎlǐ qù.)

Q12. "Why does God need our worship? Is He insecure?" 真主为什么需要我们崇拜他？

God needs nothing: "You are the ones in need of God; God is Free of need" (35:15; also 51:56-57). Worship benefits us, not Him. The sun does not need you to face it, but you need it to feel warm. Worship is gratitude to the One who gave you eyes, parents and every breath; it reminds you of your purpose and keeps you humble and honest [13]. Chinese culture honours parents out of gratitude (孝 xiào); worship is gratitude to the Source of everything.

中文: 真主不需要任何东西。崇拜是为了我们自己，不是为了他。就像你孝敬父母，是因为感恩。崇拜是对给了我们一切的主的感恩。(Zhēnzhǔ bù xūyào rènhé dōngxi. Chóngbài shì wèi le wǒmen zìjǐ, bú shì wèi le tā. Jiù xiàng nǐ xiàojìng fùmǔ, shì yīnwèi gǎn'ēn. Chóngbài shì duì gěi le wǒmen yíqiè de Zhǔ de gǎn'ēn.)

Q13. "A loving God would not send people to hell." 慈爱的神不会把人送进地狱

A loving God is also a just God. Would you call a judge "loving" if he let every murderer walk free? God's mercy is greater: "My mercy prevails over My wrath" [14]; He forgives all sins for anyone who sincerely repents (39:53); and those whom the message never clearly reached are not punished for it (17:15). Hell is for knowing, persistent rejection and evil, after reason, conscience and messengers were given [15]. Islam does not say good non-Muslims and evil people are the same; God judges each person by what they knew and what they did.

中文: 慈爱的主也是公正的主。如果法官让所有杀人犯都自由，你会说他慈爱吗？真主原谅所有真心悔改的人。没有听到过信息的人，不会因此被惩罚。(Cí'ài de Zhǔ yě shì gōngzhèng de Zhǔ. Rúguǒ fǎguān ràng suǒyǒu shārénfàn dōu zìyóu, nǐ huì shuō tā cí'ài ma? Zhēnzhǔ yuánliàng suǒyǒu zhēnxīn huǐgǎi de rén. Méiyǒu tīng dào guo xìnxī de rén, bú huì yīncǐ bèi chéngfá.)

Q14. "If God knows everything, we have no free will." 真主知道一切，那我们没有自由

Knowing is not forcing. A teacher who knows a lazy student will fail did not make him fail. God is outside time; He sees your choice but does not make it for you. The Quran says "whoever wills, let him believe, and whoever wills, let him disbelieve" (18:29) [16]. The atheist has the bigger problem: if we are only atoms following physical laws, there is no free will at all, and even his atheism was not freely chosen.

中文: 知道不等于强迫。老师知道懒学生会不及格，但不是老师让他不及格的。真主看见你的选择，但选择是你自己做的。(Zhīdào bù děngyú qiǎngpò. Lǎoshī zhīdào lǎn xuésheng huì bù jígé, dàn bú shì lǎoshī ràng tā bù jígé de. Zhēnzhǔ kànjiàn nǐ de xuǎnzé, dàn xuǎnzé shì nǐ zìjǐ zuò de.)

Q15. "Miracles are impossible. The laws of nature never break." 奇迹不可能

The laws of nature describe what normally happens; they are not a fence around God. If God made the laws, He can act beyond them, as a programmer can change his own program. Saying "miracles are impossible" assumes there is no God, which is the question being discussed [17]. Islam's main miracle is not a one-time event you must take on trust; it is the Quran, a book you can examine today (Chapter 4).

中文: 自然规律是真主创造的。写程序的人当然可以改程序。伊斯兰最大的奇迹是《古兰经》，你今天还可以自己去检验。(Zìrán guīlǜ shì Zhēnzhǔ chuàngzào de. Xiě chéngxù de rén dāngrán kěyǐ gǎi chéngxù. Yīsīlán zuì dà de qíjì shì 《Gǔlánjīng》, nǐ jīntiān hái kěyǐ zìjǐ qù jiǎnnyàn.)

Q16. "What is the purpose of life? I just want to be happy." 人生的意义是什么？

This question often opens hearts, especially among young Chinese who feel the pressure of 内卷 (nèijuǎn, endless competition) and emptiness; in 2023 temple visits by young people rose sharply as a search for relief [18]. In atheism you come from nothing and go to nothing, and pleasure always fades. In Islam you were created on purpose by One who knows you, life is a short test, every good deed is kept, and the heart finds rest only in remembering its Creator (13:28). Ask: "If you got everything you want, house, car, money, then what?"

中文: 如果没有真主，你从虚无来，到虚无去。伊斯兰说：你是被有目的地创造的，你做的每一件好事都有永恒的价值。心只有在记念真主时才能安宁。(Rúguǒ méiyǒu Zhēnzhǔ, nǐ cóng xūwú lái, dào xūwú qù. Yīsīlán shuō: nǐ shì bèi yǒu mùdì de chuàngzào de, nǐ zuò de měi yí jiàn hǎoshì dōu yǒu yǒnghéng de jiàzhí. Xīn zhǐ yǒu zài jìniàn Zhēnzhǔ shí cái néng ānníng.)

Notes and evidence for Chapter 3

1. SeekersGuidance, "What should I answer when asked about God's creator?", seekersguidance.org; Hamza Tzortzis, "Divine Link: The Argument from Dependency", hamzatzortzis.com.
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3. Francis S. Collins, *The Language of God* (Free Press, 2006).
4. Yaqeen Institute, "Human Origins, Parts 1 and 2", part 1, part 2.
5. Hamza Tzortzis, "On Professor Lawrence Krauss's 'Nothing'", hamzatzortzis.com.
6. Yaqeen Institute, "Why Do People Suffer?" and "The Problem of Evil: A Multifaceted Islamic Solution", yaqeeninstitute.org.
7. Sahih al-Bukhari 5641-5642; Sahih Muslim 2573.
8. Charles Phillips and Alan Axelrod, *Encyclopedia of Wars* (Facts on File, 2004), 3 vols.
9. R. J. Rummel, *Death by Government* (Transaction, 1994).
10. Hamza Tzortzis, "Know God, Know Good" (Chapter 2, note 7).
11. Karl Marx, *A Contribution to the Critique of Hegel's Philosophy of Right*, introduction (1844).
12. Guinness World Records, "Oldest university" (University of al-Qarawiyyin, Fez, 859 CE); UNESCO lists the Medina of Fez as World Heritage.
13. Yaqeen Institute, "Why Does God Ask People to Worship Him?", yaqeeninstitute.org.
14. Sahih al-Bukhari 3194; Sahih Muslim 2751.
15. Yaqeen Institute, "The Infinitely Merciful and the Question of Hellfire" and "The Fate of Non-Muslims", yaqeeninstitute.org.
16. Yaqeen Institute, "Predestination vs. Free Will in Islam", yaqeeninstitute.org.
17. Yaqeen Institute, "The Physical Miracles of Prophet Muhammad", yaqeeninstitute.org.
18. Sixth Tone, "Young Chinese embrace temple visits to evade life's pressures" (2023), sixthtone.com. Part IV, section 3.

Chapter 4: Why Islam: the evidence in brief

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s04

Once a person accepts that a Creator probably exists, the next question is: “Which message is from Him?” This chapter is the short version you speak from. Part II has the full evidence with grades.

4.1 The ladder for someone who starts with no belief

Most Chinese people are at step 0, so do not start with the Quran. Climb one step per conversation if needed:

1. **Purpose.** “Do you ever ask why we are here?” Listen first (Chapter 3, Q16).
2. **Origin.** “Did the universe come from nothing, from itself, or from a Creator?” (52:35-36; Chapter 2).
3. **One God, no idols.** Tawhid is simple and reasonable: one Creator, no partners, no images, no middlemen.
4. **God would communicate.** If a Creator made us on purpose, He would tell us why. So look for a message that is preserved, consistent, and contains what no human of its time could have produced.
5. **The Quran passes that test.** Sections 4.2 to 4.6.
6. **Living Islam.** Visit a registered mosque together (the Great Mosque of Xi'an or Niujie in Beijing are ideal), share halal food, meet Chinese Muslims. Many hearts open through experience, not debate.

中文: 如果有创造者，他一定会告诉我们为什么创造我们。所以我们要找一个保存完整、前后一致的信息。(Rúguǒ yǒu chuàngzàozhě, tā yídìng huì gàosu wǒmen wèishénme chuàngzào wǒmen. Suǒyǐ wǒmen yào zhǎo yí ge bǎocún wánzhěng, qiánhòu yízhì de xìnxī.)

4.2 The Quran is preserved

- The Birmingham Quran manuscript has been radiocarbon-dated to 568-645 CE, and its text matches today's Quran [1]. The Tubingen manuscript dates to 649-675 CE and the Paris-St Petersburg codex to about 650-675 CE [2].
- Western academics now treat the standard text as fixed by about 650 CE. Nicolai Sinai of Oxford: the traditional dating “ought to be our default view”; Marijn van Putten of Leiden shows that early manuscripts share spelling quirks that prove copying from one written original [3].
- The Quran has also been memorised word for word in every generation, by people in every country, and is recited identically from Morocco to China.
- Quran 15:9: “We have sent down the Reminder, and We will surely guard it.” A 1,400-year-old promise, still kept.

中文: 最早的《古兰经》手稿（英国伯明翰大学，碳十四测定为公元 568 到 645 年）和今天的《古兰经》文字一致。(Zuì zǎo de 《Gǔlánjīng》 shǒugǎo, Yīngguó Bómínghan Dàxué, tàn shísì cèdìng wéi gōngyuán 568 dào 645 nián, hé jīntiān de 《Gǔlánjīng》 wénzì yízhì.)

4.3 The Quran and the natural world

The Quran is not a science textbook. The honest claim is this: a book revealed in the 7th century to a man who could not read describes the natural world in ways consistent with modern knowledge, and contains no statement that science has shown to be false [4]. Use only the examples whose Arabic is plain (grade A in Part II):

Topic	Verse	What we know today
Every living thing made from water	21:30	Life is water-based; cells are mostly

Topic	Verse	What we know today
		water
Stages of the embryo: a drop, a clinging thing (alaqah), a chewed-like lump (mudghah), then bones clothed with flesh	23:12-14	Matches the visible stages of development; the embryo clings to the womb and somites look like tooth marks [5]
Three darknesses around the unborn child	39:6	Abdominal wall, uterine wall, and the membranes around the embryo
Darkness in the deep sea, waves above waves	24:40	Sunlight is absorbed in the upper 200 m; internal waves move between water layers [6]
Two seas meeting with a barrier between	25:53; 55:19-20	Bodies of water of different salinity and density keep their identity where they meet
How rain clouds and hail form	24:43	Small clouds join, stack vertically into towering clouds, and produce rain and hail
Springs fed by rain	39:21	The water cycle, understood in Europe only from the 16th century
The sun and moon each swim in an orbit	21:33; 36:40	Both are in motion along orbits
The moon's light is reflected	10:5; 71:16	The Quran calls the sun a lamp (siraj) and the moon a light (nur); the moon only reflects
Milk from between digested food and blood	16:66	Nutrients pass from the gut into blood and then to the mammary glands
The male drop determines the pair	53:45-46	The father's sperm determines the child's sex

Never fight for a single example. If someone challenges one, concede and move on. Avoid the popular items that depend on one translation (expanding universe, egg-shaped earth, iron sent down, lowest land, the Pharaoh's mummy); Part II explains why [7].

中文:《古兰经》不是科学书，但它是一千四百年前启示给一个不识字的人的。它讲到胚胎的发育、深海的黑暗、云和雨的形成……而且没有一句话被科学证明是错的。(《Gǔlánjīng》 bú shì kēxué shū, dàn tā shì yì qiān sì bǎi nián qián qǐshì gěi yí ge bú shì zì de rén de. Tā jiǎng dào pēitāi de fāyù, shēnhǎi de hēi'àn, yún hé yǔ de xíngchéng… érqiě méiyǒu yí jù huà bèi kēxué zhèngmíng shì cuò de.)

4.4 The Quran's challenge

- The Quran challenges anyone to produce one chapter like it (2:23; 10:38; 17:88). The masters of Arabic, who had every reason to answer, never did [8].
- Muhammad could not read or write (7:157; 29:48), had no teacher, and composed no poetry before age 40. Then he recited a book that fits neither Arabic poetry nor prose and shaped the Arabic language ever since.
- The style never changes across 23 years of revelation, through war, peace, grief and victory. The Quran also rebukes the Prophet himself (80:1-10), which an author does not do to himself.

4.5 Prophecies fulfilled

- Rome, just defeated by Persia around 614, would win again “within a few years” (30:2-4); the Byzantine victories of 622-628 fulfilled it [9].
- The believers would enter Mecca in safety (48:27), revealed when they had just been turned away; fulfilled in 629-630.
- The Prophet foretold the fall of the Persian and Byzantine empires to a few hundred poor followers (Sahih al-Bukhari 3120) and that Islam would reach the east and the west (Sahih Muslim 2889). Within a century it reached China and Spain [10].

4.6 The Prophet's character

- Known as al-Amin, “the Trustworthy”, before prophethood, even by his enemies.
- Offered wealth and power to stop preaching; refused. He died with his armour pawned to a Jewish neighbour for barley (Sahih al-Bukhari 2916). A fraud seeks gain; he gained nothing material [11].
- He forgave the people of Mecca who had persecuted him when he returned victorious in 630.
- The historian W. Montgomery Watt (Oxford, 1953): “To suppose Muhammad an impostor raises more problems than it solves.” Michael Hart ranked him first in *The 100* (1978) as “the only man in history who was supremely successful on both the religious and secular levels” [12].

4.7 Islam makes sense

- One God, no trinity, no idols, no priests between you and God, no original sin, no one needs to die for your sins. You pray directly to your Creator.
- Guidance for every part of life (family, money, food, hygiene, justice) that has worked for 1,400 years across every culture, including China's.
- The Quran repeatedly asks “Do you not think? Do you not reflect?” Faith built on reflection, not blind obedience.
- People raised Muslim overwhelmingly remain Muslim: retention is above 90% in most countries surveyed [13]. (Do not claim Islam grows mainly by conversion; its global growth is mostly demographic.)

中文: 伊斯兰很简单：只有一个真主，没有偶像，你和真主之间不需要任何中间人。《古兰经》很多次问：“你们怎么不思考呢？”(Yīsīlán hěn jiǎndān: zhǐ yǒu yí ge Zhēnzhǔ, méiyǒu ǒuxiàng, nǐ hé Zhēnzhǔ zhī jiān bù xūyào rènhé zhōngjiānrén. 《Gǔlánjīng》 hěn duō cì wèn: “Nǐmen zěnme bù sīkǎo ne?”)

Notes and evidence for Chapter 4

1. University of Birmingham, “Birmingham Qur'an manuscript dated among the oldest in the world”, 22 July 2015, birmingham.ac.uk. Radiocarbon dates the parchment, not the ink; some scholars think the script is slightly later, but still 7th century.
2. Tubingen Ma VI 165, Corpus Coranicum dating announced 11 November 2014; Francois Deroche, *La transmission ecrite du Coran* (Brill, 2009). Part II, section 4.
3. Nicolai Sinai, “When did the consonantal skeleton of the Quran reach closure?”, *Bulletin of SOAS* 77 (2014); Marijn van Putten, “‘The Grace of God’ as Evidence for a Written Uthmanic Archetype”, *Bulletin of SOAS* 82 (2019), open access.
4. Maurice Bucaille, *The Bible, the Qur'an and Science* (1976); Hamza Tzortzis, “Does the Qur'an Contain Scientific Miracles?” (2013), which argues for “compatibility” rather than “miracle”.
5. Keith L. Moore, “A scientist's interpretation of references to embryology in the Qur'an”, *Journal of the Islamic Medical Association* 18 (1986): 15-17. Read the caveats in Part II, section 3.
6. islam-guide.com, “The Qur'an on Deep Seas and Internal Waves”, mirrored at islamreligion.com.
7. Part II, section 2, grades all 42 claims as A, B or C.

8. Hamza Tzortzis, “The Qur'an's Unique Literary Form”; *The Divine Reality* (2019), chapter 13. Part II, section 5.
9. Abul A'la Maududi, introduction to Surah al-Rum, islamicstudies.info.
10. Sahih al-Bukhari 3120-3121; Sahih Muslim 2889, 2918. Part II, section 6.
11. Sahih al-Bukhari 2916, 6458-6459.
12. W. Montgomery Watt, *Muhammad at Mecca* (Oxford, 1953), p. 52; Michael H. Hart, *The 100: A Ranking of the Most Influential Persons in History* (1978). Part II, section 7.
13. Pew Research Center, *Religious Switching Into and Out of Islam*, 26 March 2025, pewresearch.org.

Chapter 5: Questions Chinese people ask about Islam



🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s05

These come up more often than atheist arguments. Chinese people are usually curious, not hostile, so answer warmly and briefly. The Chinese course practises these in Lessons 9 and 10.

5.1 “Isn't Islam a foreign, Arab religion?” 伊斯兰是外国的宗教吧？

Islam reached China in 651 CE, in the Tang dynasty, only 19 years after the Prophet's death [1]. The Great Mosque of Xi'an (founded 742) is built entirely in Chinese style. Zheng He, the Ming admiral every Chinese child learns about, was born into a Muslim family. China has about 17 to 20 million Muslims across ten ethnic groups [2]. In the 17th and 18th centuries Chinese Muslim scholars such as Liu Zhi wrote about Islam in the language of Confucius [3]. Islam is not Arab either: only about one in five Muslims is Arab, and the largest Muslim country is Indonesia. Islam is for all humanity (21:107; 49:13).

中文: 伊斯兰在唐朝（公元 651 年）就传入中国了，已经一千三百多年。西安大清真寺是完全中国风格的。郑和是穆斯林。中国有两千万左右穆斯林。伊斯兰不是阿拉伯人的宗教，是全人类的。(Yīsīlán zài Tángcháo jiù chuánrù Zhōngguó le, yǐjīng yì qiān sān bǎi duō nián. Xī'ān Dà Qīngzhēnsì shì wánquán Zhōngguó fēnggé de. Zhèng Hé shì Mùsīlín. Zhōngguó yǒu liǎng qiān wàn zuǒyòu Mùsīlín. Yīsīlán bú shì Ālābórén de zōngjiào, shì quán rénlèi de.)

5.2 “Why don't you eat pork?” 你为什么不吃猪肉？

Short answer: God forbade it (2:173; 5:3), as He did for the Jews, and we obey the Creator the way you follow a doctor you trust without knowing every reason. Islam also forbids blood, carrion and alcohol, for purity and health; pork can carry parasites such as Trichinella and tapeworm [4]. The key idea is obedience to the One who made us. Chinese people already respect food rules (many Buddhists avoid meat). Be friendly: 清真 (halal) restaurants are everywhere in China, and a lamian shop is a perfect place to meet.

中文: 因为真主禁止了。就像你相信医生，不一定知道每一个原因。伊斯兰也禁止酒、血和死肉，都是为了健康和干净。(Yīnwèi Zhēnzhǔ jìnzhǐ le. Jiù xiàng nǐ xiāngxìn yīshēng, bù yídìng zhīdào měi yí ge yuányīn. Yīsīlán yě jìnzhǐ jiǔ, xuè hé sǐròu, dōu shì wèi le jiànkāng hé gānjìng.)

5.3 “Why do Muslim women cover their hair? Is Islam against women?” 为什么穆斯林女人要戴头巾？

Hijab is modesty and dignity: “judge me by my mind and character, not my body”. The Quran commands men to lower their gaze first, then women (24:30-31). Islam gave women the right to own property, inherit (4:7), receive the dower as their own (4:4), consent to marriage, and keep their own family name, 1,400 years ago [5]. The

Prophet said: “The best of you are those who are best to their families” and, of a mother, “stay with her, for Paradise is beneath her feet” [6]. Where women are mistreated, that is local culture breaking Islamic law. Traditional Chinese culture also valued modesty (端庄).

中文: 头巾是女人自己的选择，代表端庄和尊严，意思是“看我的品格，不要看我的身体”。伊斯兰在一千四百年前就给了女人财产权、继承权和选择丈夫的权利。(Tóujīn shì nǚrén zìjǐ de xuǎnzé, dàibiǎo duānzhuāng hé zūnyán, yìsi shì “kàn wǒ de pǐngé, bú yào kàn wǒ de shēntǐ”. Yīsīlán zài yì qiān sì bǎi nián qián jiù gěi le nǚrén cáichǎnquán, jìchéngquán hé xuǎnzé zhàngfu de quánlì.)

5.4 “Isn't Islam violent? What about terrorism?” 伊斯兰不是很暴力吗？

The Quran says killing one innocent person is like killing all humanity (5:32), forbids forcing anyone into religion (2:256), and commands justice even toward people you dislike (5:8). Fighting is permitted only in defence against aggression (22:39-40; 2:190), and the first caliph, Abu Bakr, ordered armies never to harm women, children, the elderly, monks, trees or animals [7]. Terrorists kill mostly Muslims and are condemned by Muslim scholars worldwide. Nearly two billion Muslims live peacefully; judge a religion by its book and its best followers, not its worst. In China, do not discuss Xinjiang or politics; stay with the teachings.

中文: 《古兰经》说，杀一个无辜的人就像杀了全人类。宗教不能强迫。恐怖分子杀的大多数是穆斯林，伊斯兰学者都谴责他们。世界上将近二十亿穆斯林，绝大多数都是和平的。(《Gǔlánjīng》 shuō, shā yí ge wúgū de rén jiù xiàng shā le quán rénlèi. Zōngjiào bù néng qiǎngpò. Kǒngbù fènzǐ shā de dàduōshù shì Mùsīlín, Yīsīlán xuézhě dōu qiǎnzé tāmen. Shìjiè shang jiāngjìn èrshí yì Mùsīlín, jué dàduōshù dōu shì hépíng de.)

5.5 “Why pray five times a day? Isn't that too much?” 为什么一天礼拜五次？

Each prayer takes about five minutes. It is a reset: you stop, wash and remember why you exist. Chinese people practise tai chi every morning for the body; prayer is the same discipline for the soul. Research reviews link regular religious practice with lower depression and better coping [8]. It also keeps a person honest all day: it is hard to cheat at two o'clock when you will stand before God at three.

中文: 每次礼拜只要五分钟。就像你们每天练太极是为了身体，礼拜是为了心灵。它让人一整天都记得自己是谁、为什么活着。(Měi cì lǐbài zhǐ yào wǔ fēnzhōng. Jiù xiàng nǐmen měi tiān liàn tàijí shì wèi le shēntǐ, lǐbài shì wèi le xīnlíng. Tā ràng rén yì zhěng tiān dōu jìde zìjǐ shì shéi, wèishénme huózhe.)

5.6 “What about my parents and ancestors? Does Islam respect family?” 伊斯兰尊重家庭吗？

Strongly. The Quran places kindness to parents right after the worship of God (17:23-24) and commands honouring them even if they are not Muslim (31:14-15). Visiting relatives and caring for the elderly are acts of worship. Islam forbids only praying to ancestors, because prayer belongs to God alone; remembering them, visiting their graves and giving charity in their name are encouraged. Chinese Muslim scholars summed this up as 忠主孝亲, “loyal to the Lord, filial to parents” [3].

中文: 《古兰经》把孝敬父母放在崇拜真主之后。父母不是穆斯林也要孝敬。伊斯兰只是不允许向祖先祈祷，因为祈祷只属于真主。纪念和尊重祖先是可以的。(《Gǔlánjīng》 bǎ xiàojìng fùmǔ fàng zài chóngbài Zhēnzhǔ zhī hòu. Fùmǔ bú shì Mùsīlín yě yào xiàojìng. Yīsīlán zhǐshì bù yǔnxǔ xiàng zǔxiān qídǎo, yīnwèi qídǎo zhǐ shǔyú Zhēnzhǔ. Jìniàn hé zūnzhòng zǔxiān shì kěyǐ de.)

5.7 “How is Islam different from Buddhism?” 伊斯兰和佛教有什么不同？

Buddhism, as most Chinese know it, has no Creator, teaches rebirth, and seeks release from suffering through detachment. Islam teaches one Creator, one life, one judgement, and a life lived fully in the world (marriage, work, family) in service of God. Both value compassion, discipline and honesty. Buddhism asks “how do I stop

suffering?"; Islam asks "who made me and what does He want?". Many Chinese like that Islam has no statues, no monks and no middlemen.

中文: 佛教没有创造者，讲轮回。伊斯兰讲一个创造者、一次生命、一次审判。佛教问：怎么摆脱痛苦？伊斯兰问：谁创造了我，他要我做什么？(Fójiào méiyǒu chuàngzàozhě, jiǎng lúnhuí. Yīsīlán jiǎng yí ge chuàngzàozhě, yí cì shēngmìng, yí cì shěnpàn. Fójiào wèn: zěnme bǎituō tòngkǔ? Yīsīlán wèn: shéi chuàngzào le wǒ, tā yào wǒ zuò shénme?)

5.8 "Can I believe in God but not follow any religion?" 我可以信神但不信教吗？

That is a good first step; the fitrah is awake. Then ask: if the Creator made you on purpose, would He leave you with no instructions? A company that hires you gives you a job description. Follow the evidence to the message He sent. Islam does not ask for blind faith: read the Quran in Ma Jian's Chinese translation, legally sold at mosques in China, and judge for yourself [9].

中文: 这是很好的第一步。但是，如果创造者有目的地创造了你，他会不给你任何指示吗？你可以自己读马坚翻译的《古兰经》，自己判断。(Zhè shì hěn hǎo de dì-yī bù. Dànshì, rúguǒ chuàngzàozhě yǒu mùdì de chuàngzào le nǐ, tā huì bù gěi nǐ rènhé zhǐshì ma? Nǐ kěyǐ zìjǐ dú Mǎ Jiān fānyì de 《Gǔlánjīng》, zìjǐ pànduàn.)

Notes and evidence for Chapter 5

1. *Old Book of Tang* (旧唐书), embassy of 651 CE; Islam during the Tang dynasty (Wikipedia). Great Mosque of Xi'an: Wikipedia. Zheng He: Wikipedia.
2. Pew Research Center, "Islam", in *Measuring Religion in China*, 30 August 2023 (about 17 million adult Muslims), pewresearch.org; official Chinese figures count about 20 million. Part IV, section 1.
3. Liu Zhi, *Tianfang dianli* 天方典礼 and *Wugong shiyi* 五功释义; James Frankel, *Rectifying God's Name* (2011). Part IV, section 2.
4. World Health Organization, fact sheet on taeniasis/cysticercosis (Taenia solium, the pork tapeworm); US Centers for Disease Control, trichinellosis.
5. Yaqeen Institute, "Women in Islamic Law: Examining Five Prevalent Myths", yaqeeninstitute.org. Consent to marriage: Sahih al-Bukhari 5136.
6. Jami' al-Tirmidhi 3895 ("the best of you are the best to their families"), graded sahih; Sunan al-Nasa'i 3104 ("Paradise is beneath her feet"), graded hasan.
7. Muwatta Malik, Book of Jihad (Abu Bakr's instructions to the army sent to Syria). Yaqeen Institute, "Is Islam a Violent Religion?", yaqeeninstitute.org.
8. Harold G. Koenig, "Religion, Spirituality, and Health: The Research and Clinical Implications", *ISRN Psychiatry* (2012), article 278730.
9. Ma Jian (马坚), 《古兰经》中文译本 (China Social Sciences Press, 1981; bilingual edition, King Fahd Complex, 1987). Part IV, section 2.

Chapter 6: Key Quran verses and hadith

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s06

Learn the first five verses by heart in Arabic, English and Chinese. The Chinese follows Ma Jian's translation (马坚译本), the one used in Chinese mosques [1]. Lines marked * are close renderings of the meaning; check them against a printed Ma Jian Quran before quoting in public.

6.1 Verses

Verse	English meaning	中文	Use it for
112:1-4	Say: He is God, the One. God, the Eternal Refuge. He neither begets nor is born. And there is none comparable to Him.	你说：他是真主，是独一的主；真主是万物所仰赖的；他没有生产，也没有被生产；没有任何物可以做他的匹敌。	Who God is; “who created God?”
52:35-36	Were they created by nothing, or were they the creators? Or did they create the heavens and the earth? No, they have no certainty.	难道他们不凭什么而被创造呢？难道他们自己是创造者呢？难道他们曾创造天地吗？不然，他们不确信。*	The origin argument
2:255 (opening)	God: there is no god but He, the Ever-Living, the Sustainer. Neither drowsiness nor sleep overtakes Him.	真主，除他外绝无应受崇拜的；他是永生不灭的，是维护万物的；瞌睡不能侵犯他，睡眠不能克服他。	Who God is
13:28	Those who believe and whose hearts find rest in the remembrance of God. Surely in the remembrance of God do hearts find rest.	他们是信道的，他们的心境，因记念真主而安静。真的，一切心境，因记念真主而安静。	Purpose; stress and emptiness
2:256	There is no compulsion in religion; truth has become clear from error.	对于宗教，绝无强迫；因为正邪确已分明了。	Islam is not forced
21:30	Do the disbelievers not see that the heavens and the earth were joined, and We separated them, and made from water every living thing? Will they not believe?	不信道的人们难道不知道吗？天地原是闭塞的，而我开天辟地，我用水创造一切生物。难道他们不信吗？*	Origin; life from water
3:190-191	In the creation of the heavens and earth and the alternation of night and day are signs for people of understanding, who remember God standing, sitting and lying down, and reflect: “Our Lord, You did not create this in vain.”	在天地的创造和昼夜的轮流之中，对于有理智的人们，确有许多迹象。*	Islam commands reflection
41:53	We will show them Our signs on the horizons and within themselves until it becomes clear to them that it is the truth.	我将在四方和在他们自身中，把我的许多迹象昭示他们，直到他们明白它确是真理。*	Signs in nature and the self
67:2-3	He created death and life to test which of you is best in deeds. You see no inconsistency in the creation of the Most	他创造了死和生，以便他考验你们谁的作为是最优美的。你在至仁主的所造物中，不能看出一点参差。*	Suffering as test; fine-tuning

Verse	English meaning	中文	Use it for
	Merciful.		
30:30	Set your face to the religion, inclining to truth: the nature (fitrah) upon which God created mankind.	你应当趋向正教，（并当遵守）真主所赋予人的本性。*	Belief is natural
5:32	Whoever kills a soul unjustly, it is as if he killed all mankind; whoever saves one, it is as if he saved all mankind.	凡枉杀一人的，如杀众人；凡救活一人的，如救活众人。*	Terrorism question
39:53	O My servants who have wronged yourselves, do not despair of God's mercy; God forgives all sins.	我的过分自害的众仆呀！你们对真主的恩惠不要绝望，真主必定赦孥一切罪过。	Mercy; hell question
17:23-24	Your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him and be good to parents... and say: “My Lord, have mercy on them as they raised me when I was small.”	你的主曾下令说：你们应当只崇拜他，应当孝敬父母……“我的主啊！求你怜悯他俩，就像我年幼时他俩养育我那样。”*	Family; filial piety
50:16	We are closer to him than his jugular vein.	我比他的命脉还近于他。	No middleman
35:24	There was no nation but a warner passed among them.	每个民族中，都曾有过一个警告者。*	Many religions
49:13	We made you peoples and tribes that you may know one another. The most noble of you before God is the most righteous.	我使你们成为许多民族和宗族，以便你们互相认识。在真主看来，你们中最尊贵者，是你们中最敬畏者。*	Islam is not only for Arabs
16:125	Invite to the way of your Lord with wisdom and good instruction, and argue with them in the best way.	你应凭智慧和善言而劝人遵循主道，你应当以最优美的态度与人辩论。*	Your method
41:33-34	Who is better in speech than one who invites to God, does good, and says “I am a Muslim”? Repel evil with what is better, and your enemy will become a close friend.	召人于真主，且力行善功……的人，在言辞方面，有谁比他还优美呢？你应当以最优美的品行去对付恶劣的品行。*	Your character
28:56	You cannot guide whom you love, but God guides whom He wills.	你不能引导你所爱的人，但真主能引导他所意欲的人。*	Results belong to God
10:101	Say: Observe what is in the heavens and the earth.	你说：你们要观察天地之间的森罗万象。	Science question

6.2 Hadith you can quote

Only authentic (sahih) or good (hasan) hadith are listed [2].

Hadith	Source	中文
None of you truly believes until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself.	Sahih al-Bukhari 13; Sahih Muslim 45	你们中任何人都不算真正信道，直到他为兄弟喜爱他为自己所喜爱的。
Every child is born upon the fitrah.	Sahih al-Bukhari 1385; Sahih Muslim 2658	每个婴儿都是在天性上出生的。
The best of you are those who are best to their families.	Jami' al-Tirmidhi 3895 (sahih)	你们中最好的人，是对家人最好的人。
My mercy prevails over My wrath. (hadith qudsi)	Sahih al-Bukhari 3194; Sahih Muslim 2751	我的慈悯胜过我的恼怒。
I was sent only to perfect good character.	al-Bukhari, *al-Adab al-Mufrad* 273; Musnad Ahmad (sahih)	我受派遣，只是为了成全高尚的品德。
The strong man is not the one who overpowers others, but the one who controls himself when angry.	Sahih al-Bukhari 6114; Sahih Muslim 2609	强者不是能摔倒别人的人，而是发怒时能控制自己的人。
Your smile in your brother's face is charity.	Jami' al-Tirmidhi 1956 (hasan)	你对兄弟微笑，也是一种施舍。
Stay with your mother, for Paradise is beneath her feet.	Sunan al-Nasa'i 3104 (hasan)	你要陪伴你的母亲，因为天堂在她的脚下。

Pair the first hadith with Confucius: 己所不欲，勿施于人 (*Analects* 15.24). It is one of the strongest bridges you have.

6.3 Sayings not to attribute to the Prophet

These circulate widely in dawah talks but are weak or fabricated. Quoting them to an educated listener damages your credibility [3].

- “Seek knowledge even in China.” Very weak; al-Albani graded it baseless. You can say: “A famous saying, though not authentic, links seeking knowledge with China”, or simply leave it out.
- “The ink of the scholar is holier than the blood of the martyr.” Fabricated.
- “Paradise lies at the feet of mothers” in that exact short wording is weak; use the Nasa'i version above.

Notes and evidence for Chapter 6

1. Ma Jian (马坚), 《古兰经》 (China Social Sciences Press, 1981; Arabic-Chinese edition, King Fahd Complex, Madinah, 1987); online at quranenc.com/zh. English meanings follow Sahih International, simplified.
2. Hadith numbers follow the sunnah.com numbering; check each at sunnah.com.
3. Muhammad Nasir al-Din al-Albani, *Silsilat al-Ahadith al-Da'ifah wa al-Mawdu'ah*, no. 416 (“seek knowledge even in China”). Ask your local ahong to confirm gradings before you teach.

Chapter 7: Speaking: openers, phrases and the one-minute message



🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s07

Practise these aloud with a Chinese friend or a Hui Muslim; tones matter. When your Chinese runs out, show the sentence on your phone. The full vocabulary is in Appendix A, and Part V teaches every sentence step by step.

7.1 Opening a conversation

中文	Pinyin	English
你好，我是穆斯林，来自孟加拉国。	Nǐ hǎo, wǒ shì Mùsīlín, láizì Mèngjiālāguó.	Hello, I am a Muslim from Bangladesh. (change the country as needed)
我的中文不太好，请慢一点说。	Wǒ de Zhōngwén bú tài hǎo, qǐng màn yìdiǎn shuō.	My Chinese is not good; please speak a little slower.
我可以问你一个问题吗？	Wǒ kěyǐ wèn nǐ yí ge wèntí ma?	May I ask you a question?
你有宗教信仰吗？	Nǐ yǒu zōngjiào xìnyǎng ma?	Do you have a religious belief?
你相信命运吗？谁安排命运？	Nǐ xiāngxìn mìngyùn ma? Shéi ānpái mìngyùn?	Do you believe in fate? Who arranges fate? (often better than asking about religion)
你觉得宇宙是怎么来的？	Nǐ juéde yǔzhòu shì zěnme lái de?	Where do you think the universe came from?
你觉得人生的意义是什么？	Nǐ juéde rénshēng de yìyì shì shénme?	What do you think the meaning of life is?
你有没有想过，人死了以后会怎么样？	Nǐ yǒu méiyǒu xiǎng guo, rén sǐ le yǐhòu huì zěnmeyàng?	Have you ever thought about what happens after death?
你对伊斯兰教了解多少？	Nǐ duì Yīsīlánjiào liǎojiě duōshǎo?	How much do you know about Islam?

7.2 During the conversation

中文	Pinyin	English
这是个好问题。	Zhè shì ge hǎo wèntí.	That is a good question.
你说得有道理，不过……	Nǐ shuō de yǒu dàolǐ, búguò…	What you say makes sense, but…
你的意思是……对吗？	Nǐ de yìsi shì… duì ma?	You mean…, right?
我举个例子。	Wǒ jǔ ge lìzi.	Let me give an example.
伊斯兰不但不反对科学，而且鼓励科学。	Yīsīlán búdàn bù fǎnduì kēxué, érqiě gǔlì kēxué.	Islam not only does not oppose science, it encourages it.
伊斯兰是理性的宗教，不是盲目的信仰。	Yīsīlán shì lǐxìng de zōngjiào, bú shì mángmù de xìnyǎng.	Islam is a religion of reason, not blind faith.
我们只崇拜一个真主，没有偶像。	Wǒmen zhǐ chóngbài yí ge Zhēnzhǔ, méiyǒu ǒuxiàng.	We worship only one God, with no idols.
我不确定，我查一下再告诉你。	Wǒ bù quèdìng, wǒ chá yíxià zài gàosu nǐ.	I am not sure; I will check and tell you.
我们不用争论，慢慢讨论。	Wǒmen búyòng zhēnglùn, mànmān tǎolùn.	We do not need to argue; let's discuss slowly.

7.3 Closing warmly

中文	Pinyin	English
感谢你这么开放地和我聊。	Gǎnxiè nǐ zhème kāifàng de hé wǒ liáo.	Thank you for talking with me so openly.
希望你自己思考一下。	Xīwàng nǐ zìjǐ sīkǎo yíxià.	I hope you will think about it yourself.
如果你有兴趣，我们可以一起去清真寺看看。	Rúguǒ nǐ yǒu xìngqù, wǒmen kěyǐ yìqǐ qù qīngzhēnsì kànkan.	If you are interested, we can visit a mosque together.

中文	Pinyin	English
我们一起去吃清真菜吧。	Wǒmen yìqǐ qù chī qīngzhēn cài ba.	Let's go and eat halal food together.
不管你信不信，我们都是朋友。	Bùguǎn nǐ xìn bú xìn, wǒmen dōu shì péngyou.	Whether you believe or not, we are friends.

7.4 The one-minute message

Memorise this. Part V, Lesson 12, explains it word by word.

我相信宇宙有一个创造者，因为宇宙有开始，而且非常精密。创造者只有一个，他没有形象，没有伙伴。他创造我们是有目的的：认识他、感谢他、做好人。他派了很多先知，最后一个是穆罕默德，带来了《古兰经》。《古兰经》一千四百年没有改变过。这就是伊斯兰。很简单，很理性。如果你有兴趣，我们可以慢慢聊。

Wǒ xiāngxìn yǔzhòu yǒu yí ge chuàngzàozhě, yīnwèi yǔzhòu yǒu kāishǐ, érqiě fēicháng jīngmì. Chuàngzàozhě zhǐ yǒu yí ge, tā méiyǒu xíngxiàng, méiyǒu huǒbàn. Tā chuàngzào wǒmen shì yǒu mùdì de: rènshi tā, gǎnxiè tā, zuò hǎorén. Tā pài le hěn duō xiānzhī, zuìhòu yí ge shì Mùhǎnmòdé, dàilái le 《Gǔlánjīng》. 《Gǔlánjīng》 yì qiān sì bǎi nián méiyǒu gǎibiàn guo. Zhè jiù shì Yīsīlán. Hěn jiǎndān, hěn lǐxìng. Rúguǒ nǐ yǒu xìngqù, wǒmen kěyǐ mànmān liáo.

“I believe the universe has a Creator, because it had a beginning and it is extremely precise. There is only one Creator; He has no image and no partner. He created us for a purpose: to know Him, thank Him and be good people. He sent many prophets; the last was Muhammad, who brought the Quran. The Quran has not changed in 1,400 years. That is Islam: very simple, very rational. If you are interested, we can talk more over time.”

Chapter 8: When someone wants to become Muslim, and your own character

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p1.html#s08

A dawah book is incomplete if it stops at the argument. This chapter covers the moment a friend says “I want to know more” or “I want to become Muslim”, how to handle it inside Chinese law, what a new Muslim needs in the first months, and the character that makes your words believable.

8.1 Do not rush

“There is no compulsion in religion” (2:256). A decision made under pressure does not last. Make sure your friend understands three things before anything else: there is one God with no partner; Muhammad is His final messenger; and Islam is a way of life, not only a belief. If they still have serious doubts, keep talking; there is no deadline.

8.2 Explaining the shahada

The testimony of faith (清真言 qīngzhēnyán) is the door into Islam.

- **Arabic:** Ash-hadu an lā ilāha illa-llāh, wa ash-hadu anna Muḥammadan rasūlu-llāh.
- 中文: 我作证：万物非主，唯有真主；我又作证：穆罕默德是真主的使者。(Wǒ zuòzhèng: wànwù fēi zhǔ, wéi yǒu Zhēnzhǔ; wǒ yòu zuòzhèng: Mùhǎnmòdé shì Zhēnzhǔ de shǐzhě.)

- **English:** I bear witness that there is no god but God, and I bear witness that Muhammad is the messenger of God.

Explain the six articles of faith (六信: 信真主、信天仙、信经典、信使者、信后世、信前定; belief in God, angels, scriptures, messengers, the Last Day and divine decree) and the five pillars (五功: 念、礼、斋、课、朝) as they appear in the hadith of Jibril [1].

8.3 The lawful path in China

As a foreigner you must not "develop followers among Chinese citizens" or run religious classes for them (Chapter 1, section 1.2). The right path is also the best path:

1. **Introduce your friend to the ahong** (阿訇, imam) at a registered mosque in your city. Go with them the first time if they want.
2. **Let the ahong guide the shahada** and the first lessons. Chinese imams have welcomed Han Chinese into Islam for centuries and know the language, the family questions and the local rules far better than you.
3. **Connect them to the local Muslim community,** especially Hui families, who can support them in Chinese.
4. **Remain their friend.** Friendship is not regulated; keep eating together, answering questions, and caring for them.

中文: 如果你想更多了解，我可以带你去清真寺见阿訇，他会用中文给你讲得比我更清楚。(Rúguǒ nǐ xiǎng gèng duō liǎojiě, wǒ kěyǐ dài nǐ qù qīngzhēnsì jiàn āhōng, tā huì yòng Zhōngwén gěi nǐ jiǎng de bǐ wǒ gèng qīngchu.) "If you want to know more, I can take you to the mosque to meet the ahong; he will explain it in Chinese more clearly than I can."

8.4 The first months of a new Muslim

The Prophet said: "Make things easy and do not make them difficult; give good news and do not drive people away" [2].

- **One step at a time.** First the shahada and the basic belief; then learning to pray, starting with al-Fatiha; then halal food. Do not hand over a list of fifty rules on day one.
- **Family first.** Honour non-Muslim parents and stay close to them (31:14-15). Many Han converts face worried families; patience and kindness are the answer, not argument.
- **Keep the Chinese name.** A new Muslim does not need to change their name unless its meaning is bad. They may add a Muslim name if they wish.
- **Keep life stable.** Keep their job, their studies and their friends. Islam is lived inside ordinary Chinese life, as Hui Muslims have done for centuries.
- **Community.** Encourage Friday prayer at the mosque, iftar in Ramadan, and friendship with practising Chinese Muslims of their own age.
- **Learning in Chinese.** Ma Jian's Quran, the Chinese edition of *A Brief Illustrated Guide to Understanding Islam*, and the teaching of the local ahong (Part IV, section 6).

8.5 When someone says no

Stay friends. "For you your religion, and for me mine" (109:6). Many people need years; some accept Islam long after the first conversation, often because a Muslim friend never stopped being kind. Never insult, never pressure, never stop caring.

中文: 不管你信不信，我们都是朋友。(Bùguǎn nǐ xìn bú xìn, wǒmen dōu shì péngyou.)

8.6 Your own character is the strongest evidence

“Who is better in speech than one who invites to God, does good, and says ‘I am a Muslim’? Repel evil with what is better, and your enemy will become like a close friend” (41:33-34). The Prophet said he was sent “only to perfect good character” [3].

- **Be honest in small things:** money, time, promises, work. Chinese colleagues notice.
- **Control anger** (Sahih al-Bukhari 6114) and smile (Jami' al-Tirmidhi 1956).
- **Keep learning.** Study with a qualified scholar; check every claim before you repeat it (Part II).
- **Make du'a for the people you talk to.** Guidance is from God alone (28:56). A simple prayer: Allahumma-hdihim, “O God, guide them.”
- **Be patient.** The Prophet Nuh called his people for 950 years (29:14). Your success is in your effort and sincerity, not in numbers.

Notes and evidence for Chapter 8

1. Sahih Muslim 8 (hadith of Jibril: islam, iman, ihsan). Chinese terms as used by the Islamic Association of China and in Liu Zhi's *Wugong shiyi*.
2. Sahih al-Bukhari 69; Sahih Muslim 1734.
3. al-Bukhari, *al-Adab al-Mufrad* 273; Musnad Ahmad 8952 (graded sahih by al-Albani).

Part II: The Evidence Library

The full evidence bank behind the handbook: every claim the free dawah literature makes, with the verse, the source, and an honest note on how strong it is. Use the handbook to speak; use this tab to prepare and to check.

How to read this library

This material was collected on 27 October 2026 from the free online dawah literature (islam-guide.com and its mirrors on islamreligion.com and IslamHouse, Dr Zakir Naik's *The Qur'an and Modern Science*, Maurice Bucaille, Harun Yahya, Sapience Institute and Hamza Tzortzis, Yaqeen Institute, Islam Q&A, Bilal Philips) plus academic and sceptic sources for the caveats. The research environment could run web searches but could not open pages in full, so every item was confirmed only through the search engine's quoted extract of the page. Before you print anything, open the source link and check the wording yourself.

Labels used in the tables:

- **S** = the claim, the verse and the source were confirmed through a quoted extract of that page.
- **K** = standard content of the named dawah book, written from knowledge of that literature; the link is the known location but was not confirmed this time.
- **Unverified** = a quote or figure that circulates in dawah material but could not be traced to a primary source. Do not use it in public until you have checked it.
- **Drop** = a popular item that careful Muslim scholars themselves reject or that has been shown false. Leave it out.

Honesty rules for using evidence in dawah. These come from the dawah scholars themselves (Hamza Tzortzis's 2013 essay withdrawing the “scientific miracles” approach, Yasir Qadhi's warning that over-reading miracles “makes Muslims look foolish to non-Muslims”, and Yaqeen's apologetics guidelines):

1. Say “consistent with”, not “predicted”. A 7th-century text that makes no demonstrable scientific error is a defensible claim; “the Quran predicted the Big Bang” is not.
2. Use the items whose Arabic is plain in any translation (life from water, embryo stages, deep-sea darkness, two seas, milk, three darknesses). Flag the translation-dependent ones (lowest land, egg-shaped earth, expanding, iron sent down) as “possible readings” or leave them out.
3. Never fight for one example. If a sceptic challenges it, concede and move on. The strength is the pattern.
4. Do not quote the retracted scientist testimonials (Hay, Kroner). Quote Keith Moore only with context.
5. Pair science with the stronger evidences: preservation, the literary challenge, prophecy, the Prophet's character, and the arguments for God in the handbook. The dawah organisations now put those first.

Quran and modern science: the full catalogue

42 claims as the dawah literature presents them. The “Claim” column states what the literature says science found; the “Strength” column is my honest grading for use with a sceptical Chinese audience: **A** = plain Arabic, use freely; **B** = reasonable but interpretive, present as a possible reading; **C** = translation-dependent or disputed, avoid with sceptics.

Cosmology and astronomy

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
1	Heavens and earth once joined, then separated	21:30	Universe began as a single entity (Big Bang; Lemaitre 1927, Hubble 1929, CMB 1965)	islam-guide ch1-1-c; islamreligion.com/en/articles/212	S	B
2	Universe from “smoke” (dukhan)	41:11	Early universe was hot opaque gas	islamreligion.com/en/articles/212; Naik	S	B
3	Expanding universe (la-musi'un)	51:47	Hubble 1929	islamreligion.com/en/articles/1560; Naik	S	C (classical reading “vast / able”)
4	The sun runs to a fixed term	36:38, 13:2	Sun has finite fuel	Naik, astronomy section	S	B
5	Sun and moon each “swim” in an orbit	21:33, 36:40	Sun orbits the galactic centre and rotates	Bucaille, “Celestial Organization”; Naik	S	A
6	Moon's light is reflected (nur), sun a lamp (siraj)	10:5, 71:15-16, 25:61	Moon only reflects	Naik; ayatalquran.com	S	A
7	Earth “egg-shaped” (dahaha); night wrapped over day	79:30, 39:5	Oblate spheroid	Naik	S	C (dahaha classically “spread out”; Muslim apologists reject the egg reading)
8	Sky as a protected ceiling	21:32	Atmosphere, ozone, magnetosphere	islamweb 235357; Harun Yahya	S	B
9	Sky “that returns”	86:11	Rain cycle, ionosphere reflection	Harun Yahya	K	B
10	Seven heavens / layers	41:12, 65:12	Atmospheric layers	Harun Yahya	K	C
11	Smaller than an atom's weight	10:61, 34:3	Subatomic particles	Naik	K	B
12	Positions of the stars, a	56:75-76	Stellar distances	Naik; Harun Yahya	K	B

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
	mighty oath					
13	Passing beyond the heavens only with "authority"	55:33	Space travel needs technology	Naik	K	C
14	Retreating, sweeping stars	81:15-16	Black holes	Harun Yahya	K	C
15	The piercing star	86:1-3	Pulsars	Harun Yahya	K	C
16	A day like a thousand years	22:47, 70:4, 32:5	Relativity of time	Harun Yahya	K	C

Earth, oceans, atmosphere, water

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
17	Mountains as pegs with roots, stabilising the crust	78:6-7, 16:15, 21:31	Isostasy, mountain roots (Press and Siever, *Earth*)	islam-guide ch1-1-d; islamreligion.com/en/articles/215	S	B (sceptics: tectonics causes quakes at mountain belts)
18	Mountains move like clouds	27:88	Plate tectonics	Harun Yahya; Naik	K	C (verse is about the Last Day in classical tafsir)
19	Barrier between two seas; fresh and salt water	25:53, 55:19-20	Water masses keep identity (Davis, *Principles of Oceanography*)	islam-guide ch1-1-e; islamreligion.com/en/articles/214	S	A
20	Darkness in deep seas, waves upon waves	24:40	Light absorption below 200 m; internal waves (Gross, *Oceanography*)	islam-guide ch1-1-f; islamreligion.com/en/articles/217	S	A
21	Formation of rain clouds and hail, lightning	24:43, 30:48	Cumulonimbus formation (Anthes, *The Atmosphere*)	islam-guide ch1-1-g; islamreligion.com/en/articles/218	S	A
22	Water cycle; springs from rain	39:21, 23:18, 30:48	Correct cycle not known until Palissy 1580	Bucaille; islamweb 134578	S	A

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
23	Fertilising winds	15:22	Pollination; cloud seeding	Bucaille; Naik	K	B
24	Iron “sent down”	57:25	Iron formed in stars, not on Earth	islamreligion.com/en/articles/562	S	C (anzalna can mean “bestowed”; even dawah sites concede)
25	Lowest land (adna al-ard)	30:2-3	Dead Sea basin, lowest dry land	islamreligion.com/en/articles/1563	S	C (classical reading “nearest land”)
26	Earth's rotation implied	39:5, 36:40, 7:54	Night and day wrap continuously	Naik	K	B

Embryology, physiology, medicine

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
27	Embryo stages: drop, clinging thing (alaqah), chewed lump (mudghah), bones, flesh	23:12-14, 22:5, 40:67	Matches embryology (Moore and Persaud, *The Developing Human*)	islam-guide ch1-1-a; islamreligion.com/en/articles/216	S	A (sceptics: Galen had a similar sequence; answer: the Quran corrects Galen on several points)
28	Three darknesses	39:6	Abdominal wall, uterus, amniochorionic membrane (Moore)	islam-guide ch1-1-a	K	A
29	Sex determined by the male drop	53:45-46, 75:37-39	X and Y sperm (Painter 1921)	youngmuslimdigest.com; Naik	S	A
30	Hearing before sight	32:9, 76:2, 23:78	Fetal ear functional before eyes	Naik	K	B
31	Pain receptors in the skin	4:56	Nociceptors in skin; deep burns stop pain	Naik; scienceislam.com	S (Tejasen)	B
32	Fingertips reassembled	75:3-4	Fingerprint uniqueness (Galton 1892)	Harun Yahya; Naik	K	B
33	The lying, sinful forelock	96:15-16	Prefrontal cortex plans and lies (Seeley,	islam-guide ch1-1-b; islamreligion.com/articles/21	S	B

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
			Essentials of Anatomy)	3		
34	Milk from between excretions and blood	16:66	Digestion to blood to mammary gland	Bucaille; Naik	K	A
35	Breast tightens as if climbing into the sky	6:125	Hypoxia at altitude	Naik	K	B
36	Every living thing from water	21:30, 24:45	Protoplasm is mostly water	Naik; islam-guide	K	A

Zoology and botany

#	Topic	Verse	Claim in the literature	Source	Status	Strength
37	The bee: feminine verbs, honey heals, “ways laid down”	16:68-69	Worker bees are female; honey antibacterial; bee dance (von Frisch)	Naik; Harun Yahya	K	B
38	The speaking ant (feminine)	27:18	Ant communication; workers female	Naik; Harun Yahya	K	B
39	The spider's house (feminine verb)	29:41	Female spins the web	Harun Yahya; Naik	K	B
40	The fly that cannot be made, nor its theft recovered	22:73	External digestion	Harun Yahya	K	C
41	Animals are communities like you	6:38	Social organisation in animals	Naik	K	B
42	Pairs in plants and in “what you do not know”	36:36, 20:53, 13:3, 51:49	Plant sexuality (Camerarius 1694); matter and antimatter	Bucaille; Naik; Harun Yahya	K	B

Also circulated (all K): sun and moon “by precise calculation” (55:5); fire from the green tree (36:80); rain in due measure (43:11); earth diminished from its edges (13:41); creatures on two and four legs (24:45); the word Allah/iron numerology (Drop).

The main sceptic objections you must be ready for: hindsight reading (no verse was used to predict anything); translation dependence (items 3, 7, 24, 25); selective literalism (sceptics will raise 18:86 the sun setting in a muddy spring, 86:5-7 semen from between the backbone and ribs, 67:5 stars as missiles); prior knowledge (Greek embryology, Eratosthenes); science changes. The reply in each case: the Quran speaks in the language of its first audience and makes no scientific error; the point is compatibility, not prediction; and the stronger evidence for the Quran is elsewhere (preservation, inimitability, prophecy, the Prophet).

Scientists quoted in dawah videos

All of these quotes come from one source: the 1980s videotape *This Is the Truth*, made by the Commission on Scientific Signs in the Qur'an and Sunnah (Muslim World League, led by Sheikh Abdul-Majeed al-Zindani) and transcribed on islam-guide.com/truth.htm. Dr Zakir Naik's lectures reuse them. Use the table's right-hand column before you quote anyone.

Scientist	Occasion	Quote as circulated	Caveat
Keith L. Moore, Professor of Anatomy, University of Toronto, author of *The Developing Human*	7th Saudi Medical Conference, Dammam, 1981	"It is clear to me that these statements must have come to Muhammad from God, because almost all of this knowledge was not discovered until many centuries later." Also his 1986 article in the *Journal of the Islamic Medical Association* (18:15-17): the Quranic descriptions are "in agreement with modern embryology"	Moore does not read Arabic and worked from translations supplied by al-Zindani; he declined to comment to the *Wall Street Journal* in 2002; no primary transcript of the 1981 talk exists online. The claim that he converted is unverified and probably false. Quote the 1986 article, not the talk.
T. V. N. Persaud, Professor of Anatomy, University of Manitoba	Interview on the tape	"I have no difficulty in my mind in reconciling that this is a divine inspiration or revelation which led him to these statements."	No later statement found.
E. Marshall Johnson, Thomas Jefferson University, Philadelphia	Dammam 1981	"I see nothing here in conflict with the concept that divine intervention was involved."	Dawah sources say he first rejected the passages until discussions with al-Zindani.
Tejatat Tejasen, Chairman of Anatomy, Chiang Mai University, Thailand	8th Saudi Medical Conference, Riyadh, 1985	Declared the shahada after studying 4:56 (pain receptors) and embryology	Genuine as reported; a real conversion story you can tell.
William W. Hay, marine geologist, University of Colorado	Interview on the tape	"I think it must be the divine being."	Later said he had fallen into a "trap" in the interviews. Do not use.
Alfred Kroner, Professor of Geology, Mainz	Interview on the tape	"I think it is almost impossible that he could have known about things like the common origin of the universe."	Later said his remarks were taken "out of context"; in a 2011 interview he said parts of the Quran are not supported by science. Do not use.
Yoshihide Kozai (Tokyo Observatory), Joe Leigh	Same tape	Praise for the Quran's astronomy, genetics and	Palmer and Goeringer told the *Wall Street Journal* (23

Scientist	Occasion	Quote as circulated	Caveat
Simpson (Baylor), Gerald Goeringer (Georgetown), Allison Palmer (Geological Society of America)		embryology passages	January 2002, Daniel Golden, “Western Scholars Play Key Role in Touting 'Science' of the Quran”) they had been flown to lavish conferences and asked leading questions.

Drop entirely: the story that Jacques Cousteau converted after reading 25:53 (the Cousteau Foundation denied it in 1991; he had a Catholic funeral); the claim that Keith Moore embraced Islam; the “numerical miracle” word counts (dunya and akhira 115 each, etc.) which come from Rashad Khalifa's rejected “19” system and depend on which word forms are counted.

Why this matters for China: Chinese science students will search these names. If the first result is a retraction, you lose the whole conversation. Lead with the plain verses (items marked A above) and with Tejasen's story, which is genuine.

Preservation of the Quran



🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p2.html#s04

The strongest single evidence, because a Chinese sceptic can check it in any museum catalogue. The text in the oldest manuscripts is the text recited today.

Early manuscripts

Manuscript	Where	Dating	Notes and caveats
Birmingham (Mingana 1572a)	Cadbury Research Library, University of Birmingham	Radiocarbon (Oxford), 568-645 CE at 95.4% probability, announced 22 July 2015; parts of surahs 18-20 in Hijazi script	Same codex as Paris BnF Arabe 328(c). Prof. David Thomas: “could well take us back to within a few years of the actual founding of Islam.” Caveats: radiocarbon dates the parchment, not the ink; Deroche and Mustafa Shah think the script looks slightly later. Either way it is 7th century.
Sana'a palimpsest (DAM 01-27.1)	Dar al-Makhtutat, Sana'a, Yemen (found 1972)	Lower text radiocarbon 578-669 CE at 95%	The erased lower text is a Companion-type codex with minor variants; the upper text is the standard Uthmanic text. Sadeghi and Goudarzi (*Der Islam*, 2012) conclude the surahs were fixed before Uthman's reign. Use carefully: sceptics cite the variants; the

Manuscript	Where	Dating	Notes and caveats
			answer is that they match the reported Companion readings and were replaced by the standard text, exactly as the tradition says.
Tubingen Ma VI 165	University of Tubingen	Radiocarbon 649-675 CE at 95.4%, announced 11 November 2014; 77 folios, Quran 17:37 to 36:57	Within 20-40 years of the Prophet's death.
Codex Parisino-petropolitanus	Bibliotheque nationale de France and St Petersburg	Palaeography (Deroche, 2009): about 650-675 CE	Five scribes; the text is the Uthmanic text.
Topkapi mushaf	Topkapi Palace, Istanbul	8th century (Altikulac, 2007 facsimile)	Near complete. Not Uthman's personal copy, despite popular claims. Do not say it is.
Samarkand (Tashkent) Kufic Quran	Tashkent	Radiocarbon 775-995 CE	Also not Uthman's copy.

The Corpus Coranicum project (Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences, 2007-2024) catalogues these manuscripts and reports that radiocarbon results are generally consistent with palaeographic dating.

What Western academics say (quotable)

- **Nicolai Sinai** (Oxford), *Bulletin of SOAS* 77 (2014): “the traditional dating of the standard rasm … to 650 or earlier ought to be our default view.”
- **Marijn van Putten** (Leiden), *Bulletin of SOAS* 82 (2019), open access: fourteen early manuscripts share the same spelling quirks in the same places, which can only be explained by copying from one written archetype in the first Islamic century.
- **Hythem Sidky** (Chicago), *Journal of the International Qur'anic Studies Association* 5 (2020): all examined manuscripts descend from the regional codices Uthman sent out; the radiocarbon data “support a canonization of the text during the reign of the caliph Uthman (644-656 CE).”
- **Francois Deroche** (College de France) dates the Paris codex to 650-675 CE.

Oral transmission

- The Quran was memorised in full during the Prophet's lifetime and has been transmitted by unbroken chains (ijazah) to today; al-Dhahabi's biographical dictionary lists 437 reciters across 18 generations for the ten canonical readings.
- The popular line “millions of huffaz today” has no reliable source. Say “hundreds of thousands, in every country”, which no one disputes, or simply point to any mosque in Ramadan.
- Quran 15:9 (“We will surely guard it”) is the promise; the manuscripts above are the fulfilment.

In Chinese: 最早的《古兰经》手稿（英国伯明翰大学，碳十四测定为公元 568 到 645 年）和今天的《古兰经》文字完全一致。(Zuì zǎo de 《Gǔlánjīng》 shǒugǎo, Yīngguó Bómínghan Dàxué, tàn shísì cèdìng wéi gōngyuán 568 dào 645 nián, hé jīntiān de 《Gǔlánjīng》 wénzì wánquán yízhì.) “The earliest Quran manuscript, at the University of Birmingham in England, carbon-dated to 568-645 CE, has exactly the same text as today's Quran.”

The Quran's literary challenge (i'jaz)

The challenge verses: 2:23 and 10:38 (produce one surah like it), 11:13 (ten surahs), 17:88 (humans and jinn together cannot produce its like), 52:33-34. The challenge was issued to the masters of Arabic, who had every motive to answer it, and it was never met.

How Hamza Tzortzis presents it ("The Qur'an's Unique Literary Form"; *The Divine Reality* chapter 13): classical Arabic has two forms, poetry (sixteen metres) and prose (rhymed saj' or plain). The Quran fits neither; it is a new literary form, and the inability of any Arab in 1,400 years to produce its like is the miracle. He stresses this is a claim to be tested by Arabic experts, so for a non-Arab audience it rests on testimony.

Literary features commonly cited:

- Ring composition of Surah 2: Raymond Farrin, *The Muslim World* 100 (2010) and *Structure and Qur'anic Interpretation* (2014), finds nine concentric sections mirroring each other around the centre. (The popular claim that verse 2:143 is the exact centre is unverified; cite Farrin's structure, not the verse number.)
- Surah 55: the refrain "Which of your Lord's favours will you both deny?" occurs 31 times in a precise pattern.
- Surah 108 (al-Kawthar): ten words, three verses, cited by classical scholars as a complete miracle in miniature; al-Razi disagreed that short surahs carry the challenge. Present as a taste, not as proof.
- Word-count "pairs": drop (see above).

Non-Muslim admissions, with verification status:

Author	Quote	Status
H. A. R. Gibb, *Arabic Literature* (1926, Clarendon 1963, p. 36)	"As a literary monument the Koran thus stands by itself, a production unique in Arabic literature."	Verified on Wikiquote.
Gibb, "no man in fifteen hundred years has ever played on that deep-toned instrument…"	—	Unverified; not found anywhere. Do not use.
A. J. Arberry, *The Koran Interpreted* (1955)	"the sublime rhetoric of the original… which constitute the Koran's undeniable claim to rank among the greatest literary masterpieces of mankind"	Appears in the publisher's description; check whether it is Arberry's own preface (full scan on archive.org).
Marmaduke Pickthall, *The Meaning of the Glorious Koran* (1930), foreword	"that inimitable symphony, the very sounds of which move men to tears and ecstasy"	Verified. Note Pickthall was a convert, so it is not a non-Muslim admission; dawah texts often wrongly attribute this line to Arberry.
Karen Armstrong	"an entirely new literary form"	Quoted by Tzortzis; primary page not checked.

For a Chinese audience: this evidence is hard to feel without Arabic. Use it briefly, then invite them to hear recitation (play Surah al-Rahman) and to notice that Muslims from Nigeria to Xinjiang recite the identical text.

Prophecies

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p2.html#s06

In the Quran

Prophecy	Verse	What happened	Caveat
Rome, just defeated by Persia, will win again within three to nine years	30:2-4	Revealed about 615 after Persia took Jerusalem (614); Heraclius's campaigns 622-628 ended in Persian defeat (Nineveh, 627-628). Abu Bakr's famous wager with Ubayy ibn Khalaf is in Tirmidhi 3193-3194.	Critics argue over which battle is meant and over a variant reading; give the 622-628 window honestly. The Byzantines were at their lowest point when this was revealed, which is the force of it.
The Muslims will enter the Sacred Mosque in safety, heads shaved	48:27	Revealed after Hudaybiyyah (628) when Muslims were turned away; fulfilled by the umrah of 629 and the conquest of Mecca in 630.	Critics call it a redeemed expectation; the answer is that it was recorded before the event and fulfilled as stated.
The Quran will be preserved	15:9	See the manuscripts section.	—

In the hadith

Prophecy	Reference	Grade	Fulfilment
Barefoot, naked, destitute shepherds competing in building tall buildings	Sahih Muslim 8 (hadith of Jibril); Musnad Ahmad adds “they are the Arabs”	Authentic (Bukhari and Muslim)	Gulf skyscrapers; show a photo of Dubai or Riyadh.
The Euphrates will uncover a mountain of gold	Sahih al-Bukhari 7119; Sahih Muslim 2894	Authentic	Not yet; the Euphrates is drying behind dams. Do not overclaim.
The end of Khosrau (Persia) and Caesar (Byzantium), their treasures spent in God's cause	Sahih al-Bukhari 3120, 3121; Sahih Muslim 2918	Authentic	Sasanian empire fell in 651; Byzantium lost Syria and Egypt. Said when Muslims were a few hundred poor people.
Islam will reach the east and the west; “the earth was folded for me”	Sahih Muslim 2889; Abu Dawud 4252	Authentic	Islam reached China (651) and Spain (711) within a century. A fine example to use in China.
Constantinople will be conquered; “what a wonderful leader and army”	Musnad Ahmad; al-Hakim's *Mustadrak* 4:422, graded sahih by al-Hakim and al-Dhahabi	Grading contested by some scholars	Mehmed II, 1453.
Suraqa ibn Malik will wear the bracelets of Khosrau	al-Bayhaqi, *Dala'il al-Nubuwwa* (mursal chain)	Not in Bukhari or Muslim	Umar placed them on his wrists. A beloved story; state the grading.
“This matter will reach	Often cited as Musnad	Unverified reference this	—

Prophecy	Reference	Grade	Fulfilment
wherever night and day reach”	Ahmad 16957	time; check before using	

How to present prophecy to a sceptic: choose the ones whose text is in Bukhari or Muslim (authenticated centuries before fulfilment, with manuscripts) and whose fulfilment is undeniable: the fall of Persia, the spread to east and west, and the tall buildings. Say the grading of the others.

In Chinese: 先知说：“大地为我折叠起来，我看见了东方和西方，我的民族的统治将到达我所看见的地方。”他说这句话的时候，穆斯林只有几百人。一百年后，伊斯兰到了中国和西班牙。(Sahih Muslim 2889.)

The Prophet Muhammad as evidence

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p2.html#s07

His life (with references)

- He died with his armour mortgaged to a Jewish neighbour for thirty measures of barley (Sahih al-Bukhari 2916). Months passed with no cooking fire in his house; the family lived on dates and water (Sahih al-Bukhari 6458-6459).
- Mecca's leaders offered him wealth, leadership and marriage to stop preaching; he refused (sirah of Ibn Ishaq / Ibn Hisham, the Utbah ibn Rabi'ah episode). The famous “sun in my right hand, moon in my left” wording is from the sirah, not a graded hadith; say so.
- At the conquest of Mecca (630) he gave a general amnesty to the city that had tortured and expelled his followers, pardoning Abu Sufyan, Hind and Ikrimah among others.
- He was called al-Amin, “the Trustworthy”, before prophethood; even his enemies deposited valuables with him.
- The argument (W. Montgomery Watt, *Muhammad at Mecca*, Oxford 1953, p. 52): “His readiness to undergo persecutions for his beliefs, the high moral character of the men who believed in him … and the greatness of his ultimate achievement, all argue his fundamental integrity. To suppose Muhammad an impostor raises more problems than it solves.” (Verified.)

Non-Muslim testimonies: which are genuine

Author	Quote as circulated	Status
Michael H. Hart, *The 100* (1978)	“My choice of Muhammad to lead the list of the world's most influential persons may surprise some readers … but he was the only man in history who was supremely successful on both the religious and secular levels.”	Genuine. Hart is an astrophysicist, not a historian; say “American author”.
W. Montgomery Watt (above)	—	Genuine.
Thomas Carlyle, *On Heroes* (1840), lecture “The Hero as Prophet”	“The lies which well-meaning zeal has heaped round this man are disgraceful to ourselves only”; “Sincerity, in all senses, seems to me the merit of the Koran.”	Genuine (Project Gutenberg 1091). Carlyle also criticises the Quran's style in the same lecture; quote fairly.
Mahatma Gandhi, *Young India*, 23	“It was not the sword that won a place	Plausible and consistently cited;

Author	Quote as circulated	Status
September 1924	for Islam … It was the rigid simplicity, the utter self-effacement of the Prophet, the scrupulous regard for pledges…"	wording varies slightly between reprints.
Alphonse de Lamartine, *Histoire de la Turquie* (1854), vol. II	"Philosopher, orator, apostle, legislator, warrior, conqueror of ideas … is there any man greater than he?"	Widely repeated; the French original has not been checked against the 1854 text. Use with "attributed to".
Annie Besant, *The Life and Teachings of Muhammad* (1932)	"It is impossible for anyone who studies the life and character of the great Prophet of Arabia … to feel anything but reverence…"	Only on Islamic sites; plausible but unverified.
George Bernard Shaw, "The Genuine Islam" (1936)	"He must be called the Saviour of Humanity…"	Drop. The International Shaw Society calls the source bogus; Shaw's documented 1933 letter calls Islam "ferociously intolerant".

For China: Michael Hart's ranking is the one that lands with Chinese listeners, because they respect rankings and achievement. Pair it with the poverty at his death: a man who could have been a king died with his armour pawned. 一个可以做国王的人，死的时候盔甲还抵押着。

Historical-accuracy claims and their caveats

These are popular on YouTube. Each has a real point and a real weakness; know both.

Claim	Dawah presentation	Caveats	Verdict
Pharaoh's body preserved as a sign (10:92)	Maurice Bucaille examined the mummy of Ramesses II in Paris in 1976 and presented the body's survival as fulfilment; islamreligion.com and Arab News retell his conversion	Egyptologists do not identify which pharaoh was the Exodus pharaoh (Ramesses II died of old age at about 90; Merneptah's CT scans show no drowning); classical tafsir reads the verse as the body being cast ashore for the Israelites to see; Bucaille's conversion is itself contested	Use the verse's own point: the Quran says the body was saved, and pharaohs' bodies did survive, unlike the Bible's silence. Do not name a specific mummy or claim drowning evidence.
Haman in Egypt (28:6, 28:38)	The name appears on an Egyptian stela (Vienna) with a title linked to construction, unknown before hieroglyphs were deciphered	Egyptologists read the name differently (built on the god Hemen) and date the man to another period; the identification is not accepted	Weak. Present at most as "the Quran places Haman in Egypt, and the Bible's Haman is Persian; the Quran did not copy the Bible".
"King" in Joseph's story, "Pharaoh" in Moses's story	The title Pharaoh became a royal title only in the New Kingdom; the Quran uses "king" for Joseph's time and "Pharaoh" for Moses's, where Genesis uses	Shows consistency, not independent proof; chronology of Joseph is open	Good minor point; Yaqeen Institute uses it.

Claim	Dawah presentation	Caveats	Verdict
	"Pharaoh" for both		
Lowest land (30:3)	The Byzantine defeat occurred near the Dead Sea, the lowest dry land on earth	Classical reading is "nearest land"; the double meaning is lexical, not consensus	Present only as a possible double meaning.
Iram of the Pillars (89:6-8) = Ubar, Oman	Nicholas Clapp's 1992 satellite-aided expedition found a caravan fortress at Shisr	Scholars do not accept the identification; Iram may be a tribe or region	Drop.

Rule: a Chinese sceptic with a phone will check Wikipedia in thirty seconds. Use only what survives that check.

Growth of Islam today

Figures from Pew Research Center, reported in June 2025 and March 2025.

Measure	Figure	Source
Muslims worldwide, 2020	about 2.0 billion (25.6% of humanity)	Pew, *How the Global Religious Landscape Changed from 2010 to 2020*, 9 June 2025
Growth 2010-2020	+347 million, more than all other religions combined	Same
Projected share in 2050	about 30%, roughly equal to Christians	Pew, *The Future of World Religions*, 2 April 2015
Retention of people raised Muslim	above 90% in most countries surveyed	Pew, *Religious Switching Into and Out of Islam*, 26 March 2025
US Muslims raised outside Islam	about one in five	Same

Be honest about the cause. Pew's Conrad Hackett: "very little of the change in Muslim population size is a result of people becoming Muslim as adults." The growth is mainly demographic (young population, high birth rate). The honest dawah point is different and stronger: Islam has the highest retention of any major religion, and the unaffiliated gain mostly from Christianity, not from Islam. People who are born Muslim overwhelmingly stay Muslim.

Notable converts you can name safely: Muhammad Asad (Leopold Weiss, Austrian journalist, converted 1926, author of *The Road to Mecca*); Timothy Winter / Abdal Hakim Murad (Cambridge University, Dean of Cambridge Muslim College, converted 1979); Jeffrey Lang (mathematics professor, University of Kansas, former atheist, author of *Struggling to Surrender* and *Even Angels Ask*); Dr Tejatat Tejasen (Chiang Mai, above). **Do not name:** Jacques Cousteau (hoax), Keith Moore (unverified), Maurice Bucaille (contested).

Chinese converts: there is a long tradition of Han Chinese becoming Muslim (the Han Kitab scholars wrote partly for them). Ask your local imam for living examples; a Chinese person who converted by conviction is the most persuasive witness a Chinese sceptic can meet.

Sources

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- The Quran on seas and rivers
- The Quran on deep seas and internal waves
- The Quran on clouds
- The Quran on human embryonic development
- The Quran on the cerebrum
- The miracle of iron
- The lowest point on earth
- Zakir Naik, The Quran and Modern Science (excerpt)
- Bucaille, the water cycle (islamweb)
- Scientists' comments on the Quran (islamicity)
- Commission on Scientific Signs in the Quran and Sunnah (Wikipedia; Hay and Kroner retractions)
- Tzortzis: there are no scientific miracles in the Quran (Hampshire College portal)
- Yasir Qadhi, Can Islam and science go together?
- Bigliardi, The Half-Baked Loaf (Zygon, 2024)

Preservation

- University of Birmingham: Quran manuscript dated among the oldest in the world
- Sana'a manuscript (Wikipedia)
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- Corpus Coranicum: radiocarbon dating of Quran manuscripts (PDF)
- Sinai, When did the consonantal skeleton of the Quran reach closure? (BSOAS 2014)
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- Gandhi on the Prophet (mkgandhi.org)
- Bernard Shaw quote dispute (GetReligion)

Historical claims and growth

- Islamic Awareness on 10:92
- Maarif al-Quran on 10:92 (quran.com)
- Yaqeen: Knowledge of the lost past
- Iram of the Pillars (Wikipedia)
- Pew: The future of world religions (2015)
- Pew: Religious switching into and out of Islam (2025)
- NPR on the Pew 2025 landscape report

Part III: The Objections Bank

45 objections that atheists and sceptics raise, each with the standard Islamic answer from Yaqeen Institute, Sapience Institute (Hamza Tzortzis), Islam Q&A, islamreligion.com and Zakir Naik, the verses they cite, and the source. Part I, Chapter 3 holds the 16 most common in simple form; this tab is the full bank for study.

The Islamic method for atheists

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p3.html#s01

The dawah organisations teach four things before any single argument.

1. Fitrah first. Belief in God is natural, not learned. Yaqeen Institute's case for God (Justin Parrott) rests on signs that reach "both the heart (via intuition) and the mind (through rational thought)": Quran 30:30 (the natural disposition on which God created mankind), 10:22-23 and 29:65 (people call on God alone when the ship is sinking), and the hadith "every child is born upon the fitrah" (Bukhari and Muslim). Nazir Khan's paper on Ibn Taymiyyah adds that if you doubt the God-sense you have no principled place to stop before doubting reason and the senses too. In China the fitrah shows in the language: 老天爷, 谢天谢地, 天啊.

2. The Quran's own argument, 52:35-36. "Were they created by nothing, or were they themselves the creators? Or did they create the heavens and the earth?" Hamza Tzortzis reads this as a complete set of options for anything that began: from nothing (absurd: nothing has no power), self-created (contradiction: you must exist before you act), created by something itself created (leads back to the same question), or created by something uncreated. Only the last stands. Bukhari records that Jubayr ibn Mut'im, still a pagan, heard these verses and "his heart almost began to soar".

3. The dependency argument (Ibn Sina, al-Ghazali, al-Razi; Tzortzis's "Divine Link"). Everything we see is dependent: it could have not existed and relies on something else. A chain of dependent things, even an infinite one, cannot explain itself, as an infinite row of falling dominoes does not explain why any domino fell. So there must be an independent, necessary, eternal being. This is not a God-of-the-gaps move: it reasons from what we know (dependence), not from what we do not know. Mohammed Hijab's *The Burhan* (Sapience Institute) develops the same proof.

4. The conversation, not the debate. Yaqeen's apologetics guidelines (Hatem al-Haj): building certainty is "always superior to answering doubts"; "intellectual debates rarely change deeply-held beliefs directly, often masking deeper emotional discontent or social bonds." iERA's training template, GORAP (God's existence, Oneness, Revelation, Prophethood), opens by asking what the person believes. iERA later dropped its science-miracles line; the organisations now put the philosophical and fitrah arguments first.

Sources: Yaqeen: The case for Allah's existence; Yaqeen: Atheism and radical skepticism (Ibn Taymiyyah); Tzortzis: The Quran's argument for God's existence; Tzortzis: Divine Link, the argument from dependency; Sapience: The Burhan; Yaqeen: In defense of faith, guidelines for apologetics.

Theme A: Does God exist?

A1. "Who created God?" A category error: "who made X?" applies only to things that began or depend on something. The dependency argument ends in a being that is by definition uncreated; asking who created it is like asking the bachelor's wife's name. If God had a creator, that creator would be God. Verses: 52:35-36; 112:1-4; 57:3. Sources: SeekersGuidance; Islam Q&A 87677.

A2. "Why not an infinite chain of causes?" An infinite chain of dependent things is still a collection of dependent things; it cannot explain itself (the dominoes never fall without something that is not a domino). No actual infinite has ever been shown in nature, only in mathematics. Verse: 52:35-36. Source: Tzortzis, Divine Link.

A3. "The universe came from nothing (quantum vacuum)." Lawrence Krauss's "nothing" is a quantum field with laws and energy, which is something. Absolute nothing has no properties and no power. Physicists' own critiques agree quantum-gravity models do not give "universes from nothing". Verse: 52:35. Source: Tzortzis on Krauss.

A4. "A multiverse explains fine-tuning." A universe-generator must itself be finely tuned, so the problem moves up one level. There is no empirical evidence for other universes; a mind is a simpler explanation for specified order than infinitely many unobservable worlds. Verses: 67:3; 2:164. Source: islamreligion.com, Fine-tuning part 7.

A5. "God of the gaps." The dependency argument reasons from what science confirms (everything observed is contingent and began), not from ignorance. Al-Ghazali and al-Razi used it centuries before modern science, so it is not a retreat. Source: Tzortzis, Divine Link (above).

A6. "The burden of proof is on you; atheism is just lack of belief." Atheism is a claim about reality (no God) and carries a burden too; the idea that non-belief is the neutral default came from verificationism, which is itself unverifiable. Also, God-belief is the natural default (fitrah), so the one denying it must argue. Source: *The Divine Reality*, chapter 1; Yaqeen, Ibn Taymiyyah's critique.

A7. "Extraordinary claims need extraordinary evidence." A dependent universe that is uncaused, or arose from nothing, is at least as extraordinary. The evidence for God is cumulative and ordinary (contingency, fine-tuning, consciousness, morality, the Quran). Hume's rule applied consistently would dissolve history. Source: Yaqeen, physical miracles of the Prophet.

A8. "Faith is blind." The Quran forbids following what you have no knowledge of (17:36) and condemns blind imitation of ancestors (2:170); it commands reflection more than fifty times. Islamic faith is conviction produced by signs reaching heart and mind. Verses: 17:36; 2:170; 41:53; 2:164. Source: Bilal Philips, The True Religion (islamreligion.com).

A9. "Religion is an evolutionary by-product (hyperactive agency detection)." Explaining how a belief arose does not show it false (genetic fallacy). If our faculties are only survival-tuned, naturalism undermines trust in the reasoning used to reject God. A universal, early-emerging disposition to detect a Creator is exactly what Islam predicts; calling it a "false positive" assumes atheism. Verse: 30:30. Source: Tzortzis, Life without God.

A10. "Religion is a crutch, the opium of the people." Marx's line is a sociological observation, not an argument about truth; comfort is irrelevant to truth, and the charge reverses (atheism relieves accountability). Islam's demands (fasting, five prayers, charity, restraint) are not a comfortable crutch. Verse: 13:28. Source: Marx's religious dilemma: an Islamic reply (Scirp).

A11. "You only believe because of where you were born." Genetic fallacy, and it cuts both ways: an atheist born in Riyadh would likely be Muslim, and a Chinese atheist believes what Chinese schools taught. Geography explains exposure, not truth; the answer is to test the religions by reason, which Islam invites. Islam also expects diversity, since every nation received messengers. Verses: 35:24; 16:36; 2:170.

A12. "Morality does not need God." Atheists can be moral; the claim is that atheism cannot ground morality as objectively binding. If even one moral truth is objective (torturing babies for fun is wrong), it needs a transcendent ground. And when the atheist calls suffering "evil" he borrows an objective standard his view cannot supply. Verses: 30:30; 91:7-8. Sources: Tzortzis, Know God Know Good; Yaqeen, Being a good person is not enough.

A13. Euthyphro: "Is it good because God commands it, or does God command it because it is good?" False dilemma. Goodness is God's essential nature; His commands flow from that nature, so good is neither external to God nor arbitrary. His names (the Merciful, the Just, the Wise) express this. Verse: 7:180. Source: Tzortzis, Divine commands.

A14. "Consciousness is just the brain." No physical description captures subjective experience (the hard problem; even materialist philosophers admit the explanatory gap). Islam treats the soul as distinct and the brain as its instrument; the Quran limits our knowledge of the soul (17:85) and points to signs within ourselves (41:53). Source: Solving the mind-body problem with Islamic philosophy.

A15. Near-death experiences. Not an Islamic argument. The Quran describes the intermediate state as hidden from the living (23:100); mainstream Muslim writers do not use NDEs as proof. Islam's evidence for the afterlife is God's justice and the Quran. Do not lean on NDE stories in China.

Theme B: Evil, suffering, hiddenness, prayer, free will, hell

B1. The problem of evil. Yaqeen (Elshinawy; Hani): evil is "neither a logical nor a probabilistic objection to God's existence". The logical version needs a hidden premise (God could have no good reason to permit evil) that cannot be proven; the evidential version assumes a limited human can judge what an all-wise being would permit. Islam's answer has layers: free will makes moral evil possible; life is a test (67:2, 2:155); suffering purifies, expiates sins and is compensated eternally; God's wisdom is not fully knowable (Khidr, 18:60-82); and the objection presupposes objective evil, which atheism cannot ground. Hadith: "no fatigue, disease or sorrow befalls a Muslim but God expiates sins by it" (Bukhari). Sources: Why do people suffer?; A multifaceted Islamic solution; Tzortzis, Is God merciful?.

B2. Natural disasters. Islam accepts the geology and adds meaning: reminders of mortality, tests for the afflicted and for the safe (tested in compassion), sometimes consequences of human corruption (42:30, 30:41). No one may declare a specific event a punishment; victims are compensated; children are not punished. Source: Islam Q&A 2593.

B3. Animal suffering. Animals are communities like us (6:38) and will be gathered and have wrongs settled (hadith of the hornless sheep, Muslim). They are not morally accountable, so their suffering is not punishment; Islam's welfare rules (the woman punished for a cat, the man forgiven for a dog) show God's concern. Predation is part of a wise order whose full reasons we do not know.

B4. "If God existed He would show Himself." Overwhelming manifestation would compel belief and end the test; God communicates by inspiration, from behind a veil, or through a messenger (42:51), and could have made everyone believe (10:99) but chose a world of free choice. He is not hidden: creation, fitrah and revelation are His signs (41:53). Vision cannot grasp Him (6:103) because of transcendence, not absence. Source: Divine hiddenness, an Islamic response.

B5. "Why a book? Why not direct evidence?" A preserved, public, checkable book that makes testable claims (2:23; 4:82) is better evidence than a private vision the next person can dismiss. The Quran is the miracle every generation can examine. Source: Philips, The Challenge of the Quran.

B6. "Miracles violate natural law (Hume)." Laws describe regularities, not necessities; the Lawgiver can act outside His habit. Hume's method, applied consistently, would dissolve history. The question becomes "is this miracle well attested?", not "are miracles possible?". Source: Yaqeen, physical miracles.

B7. "Prayer does not work." Every supplication free of sin is answered in one of three ways: granted now, stored as reward, or an equal harm averted (Ahmad). One is answered "so long as he does not become impatient" (Bukhari, Muslim). Prayer is worship, not a vending machine; it tests the servant, not God. Verses: 2:186; 40:60. Source: Islam Q&A 103099.

B8. Free will versus predestination. Qadar is God's eternal knowledge of and power over everything, including what people freely choose; knowing is not forcing. Islam rejected both extremes historically (denying decree, denying choice). Humans deliberate and are accountable for intention and effort; outcomes belong to God. Verses: 76:3; 18:29; 54:49. Source: Yaqeen, predestination vs free will.

B9. Hell: "infinite punishment for finite sins." Mercy is the dominant reality ("My mercy prevails over My wrath", Bukhari). Hell is for a settled disposition of knowing rejection, not a finite slip; there is no original sin; punishment is proportionate (4:40); many are released after purification; and a minority scholarly view (Ibn Taymiyyah, Ibn al-Qayyim) holds hell eventually ends. Verses: 4:40; 6:12; 11:106-107. Source: Yaqeen, the Infinitely Merciful and hellfire.

B10. "What about people who never heard of Islam?" "We never punish until We have sent a messenger" (17:15). Those the message never reached clearly (ahl al-fatrah) are excused and, per hadith, tested on the Day of Judgement; Muslims may not judge any individual to be in hell. Reaching monotheism by reflection is enough. This matters in China, where most people have never heard Islam explained properly. Verses: 17:15; 6:19; 4:48. Source: Yaqeen, the fate of non-Muslims.

Theme C and D: God's nature; science and religion

C1. "Why does God need worship? Is He egotistical, a dictator?" The verse after "I created jinn and men only to worship Me" (51:56) denies that God needs anything from us (51:57). Worship benefits the worshipper: it is gratitude to the One with all perfect attributes, and it frees the heart from worshipping lesser things (money, status, ego). A dictator extracts obedience for his own benefit; God commands what benefits us and gives free will to refuse (2:256). The "needy God" framing projects human psychology onto God. Verses: 51:56-57; 35:15; 14:8. Source: Yaqeen, Why does God ask for worship?.

C2. "God's anger and jealousy are petty human emotions." Muslims affirm God's attributes "in a manner that befits His majesty" without likening them to creatures (42:11). His anger is just displeasure at wrongdoing, which a perfectly good being must have; a God indifferent to oppression would be worse. "Jealousy" (ghayrah) in hadith means protectiveness over His rights and believers' honour, not insecurity. Verses: 42:11; 7:180. Source: Islamweb fatwa 38453.

D1. "Religion and science conflict." The "conflict thesis" is a 19th-century story; Islamic civilisation founded observatories, hospitals and the scientific method (Ibn al-Haytham), and the Quran commands observation (2:164, 3:190-191, 96:1). Science answers how; revelation answers why and who. The dawah organisations now caution against over-claiming "scientific miracles". Source: Yaqeen, Orientalists' fables about Islamic science.

D2. "Evolution disproves Adam." Yaqeen (Nazir Khan, Yasir Qadhi, David Jalajel): nothing in scripture denies mutation, natural selection, hominid species or common ancestry for other life; Adam's miraculous creation is a claim about one lineage, which empirical science (which studies regularities) cannot rule out. Evolutionary naturalism (unguided processes explain everything, including mind and morality) is a philosophical add-on that fails. A Muslim may accept the science and suspend judgement on how Adam fits. Verses: 3:59; 15:28-29; 71:14, 71:17. Sources: Human Origins I; Human Origins II.

D3. "The Quran says the earth is flat; seven heavens is primitive cosmology." "Spread out" (15:19, 71:19) describes the surface from the human viewpoint; a carpet can be spread on a curved surface, and the Quran never says "flat". Honest apologists reject Zakir Naik's "egg-shaped" reading of 79:30 as linguistically wrong. "Seven heavens" is idiom for completeness, not an astronomical model. The Quran uses the language of its audience and makes no scientific claim here; do not over-claim. Verses: 79:30; 65:12; 39:5. Source: Ghamidi on seven heavens.

Theme E: The Quran and the Prophet

E1. "Is the Quran reliably preserved?" Preserved by parallel mass memorisation and writing in the Prophet's lifetime; Abu Bakr's compilation checked each verse against written copies, memorisers and witnesses; Uthman's codex standardised the skeletal text; the minor regional readings (qira'at) strengthen rather than weaken the transmission. See the manuscripts table in the Evidence Library. Verses: 15:9; 75:17. Sources: Yaqeen, how the Quran was preserved; The Uthmanic codex.

E2. "The Quran contradicts itself." The Quran invites the test (4:82). Apparent contradictions dissolve when one verse is general and another specific, or when Arabic usage is known (six days versus the "eight" of 41:9-12, which sum overlapping periods; who takes the soul, God through His angels). Ask the sceptic for the specific verse; most have never read one.

E3. "Abrogation means God changed His mind." Naskh replaces one ruling with a later one for a community in transition, not a truth with a falsehood; most cases (alcohol) are gradual restriction leading to prohibition. A doctor adjusting treatment is wisdom, not fickleness. Verses: 2:106; 16:101. Source: SeekersGuidance on naskh.

E4. "Why Arabic? A universal God would speak to everyone." Every messenger was sent in his people's language (14:4) so the first audience could understand and be accountable; any text must have one language. Arabic was then preserved because the Quran fixed it, allowing an unbroken 1,400-year reading. Translations carry the meaning; Islam does not require Arabic to accept the message, and Ma Jian's Chinese Quran exists for this reason. Verses: 14:4; 42:7; 41:44. Source: Why was the Quran revealed in Arabic?.

E5. "The Quran was copied from the Bible." The Quran retells shared stories to correct them (Adam, Jesus) and presents itself as confirming and guarding earlier revelation from the same God (5:48), so shared content is expected on its own thesis. Borrowing would require a literate, multilingual Prophet with Syriac and Hebrew texts in Mecca, which the record contradicts (29:48; 16:103). Source: Yaqeen, the Quran's engagement with Christian and Jewish literature.

E6. "Muhammad wrote it himself." He could not read or write and dictated to scribes; the Quran's style differs sharply from his own recorded speech (hadith); it rebukes him (80:1-10; 66:1); it contains knowledge he could not have had; and it challenged his enemies to produce its like (2:23), which they never did. Verses: 2:23; 29:48; 10:16. Source: Islam Q&A 10012.

E7. The "Satanic verses" story. No authentic chain: every version is weak and none reaches the Prophet; absent from Ibn Ishaq, Bukhari and Muslim; rejected by Ibn Kathir, al-Qurtubi, Ibn Hazm and al-Albani. It contradicts the authentic report that the pagans prostrated at the end of Surah 53 and the surah's own anti-idol verses (53:19-23). Verses: 53:19-23; 22:52. Source: Refutation of the Satanic verses incident.

Theme F: Ethics and law

F1. "Islam oppresses women." Islam introduced consent to marriage, the dower as the woman's own property, inheritance rights and spiritual equality (4:1; 33:35) in 7th-century Arabia. The inheritance difference tracks financial obligations (men must maintain women; women keep their wealth), and in many cases women inherit

equally or more. The two-witness rule is limited to specific financial contracts. Hijab (24:30-31) begins with men lowering their gaze. Polygamy (4:3) is a restricted permission, not a command. Where women are mistreated, local culture is breaking Islamic law. Sources: Yaqeen, five myths about women in Islamic law; Yaqeen, gender equity at the advent of Islam.

F2. Slavery. Islam inherited a universal institution and radically regulated it: no enslavement of free people, humane treatment, equal food and clothing, no racial basis; emancipation was made an act of worship and the expiation for many sins (90:12-13; 24:33; 4:92; 5:89), so it came close to prohibition, and Muslim jurists approved abolition (Tunis, 1846). Freed slaves became leading scholars. Sources: Yaqeen, Slavery and Islam; Mawali: how freed slaves shaped Islamic scholarship.

F3. Apostasy. The Quran prescribes no earthly penalty for changing belief and affirms "no compulsion in religion" (2:256; 10:99; 18:29; 4:137). The classical penalty rests on hadith that many scholars (Shaltut, al-Qaradawi, Alalwani) read as targeting apostasy combined with treason in wartime; the Prophet never executed anyone for private loss of faith. Present it honestly as a debate among Muslims. Source: Yaqeen, the issue of apostasy.

F4. Jihad and the "sword verse" (9:5). 9:1-7 concerns specific treaty-breaking pagans, and 9:6 commands protecting any who seek safety. Fighting is permitted only against aggression (2:190), under authority, with strict rules: never women, children, the elderly or anyone not fighting (Ibn Abbas; Abu Bakr's instructions). Islam spread in Indonesia, Malaysia and China by trade, not conquest; Muslims ruled India for centuries with a Hindu majority. Verses: 9:5-6; 2:190; 2:256; 5:32; 60:8. Source: Yaqeen, Is Islam a violent religion?.

F5. "Religion causes war." The *Encyclopedia of Wars* (Phillips and Axelrod) counts about 7% of 1,763 wars as primarily religious; the 20th century's secular and atheist regimes killed far more. Misuse by adherents does not refute a religion, any more than Stalin refutes atheism. In China, make the general point and do not discuss politics. Verse: 5:32. Source: Theos, Is religion the cause of war?.

F6. The age of Aisha. Yaqeen offers several answers: by the norms of every 7th-century society she was of age, and no contemporary critic, Meccan, Jewish or Christian, objected; maturity was reached early and marriages were family-arranged across all cultures; a historical-critical minority view dates her at about 18 at consummation. Judging a 7th-century marriage by 21st-century legal ages is anachronism; Aisha became the most prolific female scholar of Islam. Sources: Understanding Aisha's age; The case for an older age.

F7. Zakir Naik's twenty common questions. His booklet *Answers to Non-Muslims' Common Questions about Islam* covers polygamy, hijab, spread by the sword, fundamentalism, meat-eating, alcohol, pork, the Kaaba, "all religions are the same", life after death, the word kafir, sects, and killing in the name of jihad. The text was located but not retrievable this time; read it at islamway.net and add his answers to this bank.

Sources

All pages were located and quoted through search extracts on 27 October 2026; none was opened in full, so check wording before citing. The links above sit beside each answer. The main collections:

- Yaqeen Institute papers (atheism, problem of evil, hellfire, fate of non-Muslims, qadar, worship, preservation, women, slavery, apostasy, violence, Aisha)
- Hamza Tzortzis essays and The Divine Reality, free online edition (Sapience Institute PDF)
- Sapience Institute: The Burhan
- islamreligion.com: Evidence Islam is truth (Bilal Philips, fine-tuning series)
- Islam Q&A answers 87677, 87534, 103099, 2593, 10012, 178209
- SeekersGuidance on God's creator, naskh, and elusive verses

- Zakir Naik, Answers to Non-Muslims' Common Questions about Islam
- Bilal Philips, The Challenge of the Quran (IslamHouse)
- iERA and the GORAP method (Birmingham PhD thesis)

Gaps to fill when you have open internet: Zakir Naik's twenty answers in full; the Divine Reality chapter by chapter; an Islamic page on Russell's teapot and on near-death experiences; the Quran 4:82 contradiction examples with tafsir.

Part IV: China Context

What you need to know about China itself: Islam's 1,300-year history there, what Chinese people actually believe today, the legal limits on foreigners, the Confucian bridges, and the Chinese Islamic vocabulary Hui Muslims use.

History of Islam in China



🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p4.html#s01

Islam has been in China for about 1,375 years. Use this freely; Chinese people respect their own history and most have no idea Islam is part of it.

Arrival. The *Old Book of Tang* records the first Arab (大食 Dashi) embassy in 651 CE, the second year of Emperor Gaozong, sent by the caliph Uthman; more than thirty embassies followed by 798. Chinese Muslim tradition says the Companion Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas led the mission and founded the Huaisheng Mosque; historians find no evidence he reached China, so present 651 as “the date in Chinese dynastic history” and the Sa'd story as “beloved tradition”. That honesty plays well.

Key mosques

Mosque	Date	Notes
Huaisheng Mosque 怀圣寺 (Guangzhou), also 光塔寺	Tradition 627; certainly Tang or early Song; rebuilt 1350 and 1695	Minaret is the oldest part; one of the oldest mosques in the world
Great Mosque of Xi'an 西安化觉巷清真大寺	Founded 742 by the mosque's own stele; present layout 1392 (Ming)	Entirely Chinese architecture; the best place to take a Chinese friend
Niujie Mosque 牛街礼拜寺 (Beijing)	996 (Liao dynasty); rebuilt 1443; named by the Chenghua Emperor in 1474	Oldest mosque in Beijing
Qingjing Mosque 清净寺 (Quanzhou)	1009 by the city's account; a 1350 stele suggests 1131	Part of the UNESCO-listed Quanzhou site (2021)

Zheng He 郑和 (1371-1433). Born into a Muslim family in Kunyang, Yunnan, descended from Sayyid Ajall Shams al-Din, the Bukharan governor of Yunnan under the Yuan; commanded the Ming treasure fleets (seven voyages, 1405-1433) to India, Arabia and East Africa. Every Chinese schoolchild knows his name; few know he was Muslim.

The Hui 回族. Descendants of Tang and Song Arab and Persian traders, plus Central Asians who came with the Mongols; under the Yuan, Muslims were the largest non-Chinese group and ranked just below the Mongols. 2020 census: 11.4 million Hui; about 11.8 million Uyghurs; ten Muslim ethnic groups in all.

Numbers today. Pew Research (30 August 2023, *Measuring Religion in China*): about 90% of adults in the ten traditionally Muslim groups identify as Muslim, giving about 17 million adult Muslims, roughly 2% of adults; official figures count about 20 million Muslims and about 35,000 mosques (63% of mosques are in Xinjiang). The Islamic Association of China (中国伊斯兰教协会, founded 1953) is the official body; its site is chinaislam.net.cn.

In Chinese: 伊斯兰在公元 651 年（唐高宗永徽二年）传入中国，《旧唐书》有记载。郑和是穆斯林。中国有十个信仰伊斯兰教的民族，大约两千万穆斯林。

The Han Kitab scholars: Islam in Confucian terms

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p4.html#s02

Your whole project was done once before, 350 years ago, by Chinese Muslims. The **Han Kitab** (汉克塔布, "Chinese books") are Islamic works written in Chinese in the 17th and 18th centuries by scholars called **Huiru** 回儒, "Muslim Confucians", trained in both traditions and centred on the mosque schools of Nanjing. They are the model for your dawah.

Scholar	Dates	Main works	What he did
Wang Daiyu 王岱舆	c. 1590-1658	*Zhengjiao zhenquan* 正教真诠 (1642), "The Real Commentary on the True Teaching"	First major Chinese Islamic book; explained Islam in a Confucian register; defined 清真: 纯洁无染为"清"，诚一不二为"真" ("unstained purity is qing; sincere oneness without duality is zhen")
Ma Zhu 马注	17th century	*Qingzhen zhinan* 清真指南, "Compass of Islam"	Written for non-Muslim elites as well as Muslims
Liu Zhi 刘智	c. 1660-c. 1730 (Nanjing)	*Tianfang xingli* 天方性理 (metaphysics), *Tianfang dianli* 天方典礼 (law and ritual), *Tianfang zhisheng shilu* 天方至圣实录 (life of the Prophet), *Wugong shiyi* 五功释义 (the five pillars)	The most systematic attempt to harmonise Islam with Chinese thought; used Neo-Confucian terms (理, 气, 太极, 道) and took ritual (礼 li) as the common ground of Confucian order and Islamic worship

Their vocabulary became the standard: 真主 (True Lord) and 真宰 (True Ruler) for Allah, avoiding 天 which could sound like an impersonal sky; 天方 ("Heavenly Square") for the Kaaba and Arabia; 清真 for Islam and the mosque; 忠主孝亲 ("loyal to the Lord, filial to parents") as the summary of duty; and Liu Zhi's pairing of the "five pillars of the way of Heaven" (天道五功: 念礼斋课朝) with the "five relationships of the way of man" (人道五典: ruler-subject, father-son, husband-wife, elder-younger, friends).

The word 清真. Originally an ordinary word meaning pure and unadorned, used by Tang and Song poets. The Hongwu Emperor's 1368 百字赞 ("Hundred-character Eulogy" of the Prophet) for the Nanjing mosque contains 教名清真, and after a Ming imperial plaque named Beijing's Dongsi mosque 清真寺 the term became general. Telling a Chinese friend that a Ming emperor wrote a eulogy of the Prophet is a strong moment.

Ma Jian 马坚 and the Chinese Quran. Ma Jian (1906-1978), Peking University professor and al-Azhar graduate, began his translation after returning to China in 1939, at first with Imam Ha Decheng. The full translation was published posthumously in 1981 by China Social Sciences Press (Beijing) and in a bilingual Arabic-Chinese edition in 1987 under the Saudi Ministry of Hajj and Endowments, the only Chinese translation recognised by the King Fahd Complex in Madinah. It is the Chinese Quran used in every mosque in China.

Scholarship to read: Sachiko Murata, William Chittick and Tu Weiming, *The Sage Learning of Liu Zhi* (Harvard, 2009); James Frankel, *Rectifying God's Name: Liu Zhi's Confucian Translation of Monotheism and Islamic Law* (Hawaii, 2011); Zvi Ben-Dor Benite, *The Dao of Muhammad* (Harvard, 2005); Kristian Petersen, *Interpreting Islam in China* (Oxford, 2018).

What Chinese people actually believe

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p4.html#s03

The typical Chinese listener is non-religious but not irreligious: no label, but likely believes in fengshui, may bow to Buddha before an exam, burns incense at Qingming, and says 老天爷 without thinking. Pew calls this "Confucianism, Taoism and Chinese folk religion". It is a far better starting point than militant atheism.

Measure	Figure	Survey
Formally identify with any religion	about 10% of adults	China General Social Survey 2018, via Pew 2023
Identify as Buddhist	4%	CGSS 2018
Believe in Buddha or a bodhisattva	33%	China Family Panel Studies 2018
Believe in fengshui 风水	47%	CFPS 2018
Burn incense at least once a year	35%	CFPS 2016
"Convinced atheist"	61% (highest in the world)	WIN/Gallup International 2015
Atheist	15%	Chinese Spiritual Life Survey 2007 (Fenggang Yang, Purdue)
Communist Party and Youth League members who did a religious practice in the past year	65%	Same

The numbers disagree because the Chinese word for "religious believer" (宗教信徒) is formal and people do not apply it to themselves; many who say "no religion" still pray at temples. So never ask 你信教吗？ first; ask about fate, heaven and ancestors.

Young people. The slang tells the story: 内卷 (involution, endless competition for less), 躺平 (lying flat; the 2021 forum post that went viral and was then censored), 佛系 ("Buddhist-style" detachment). In 2023 temple visits booked on Trip.com rose 310% year on year, half of them by people under 30; most were not Buddhists and had no specific wish; they came for relief from pressure. This is the meaning crisis the handbook's Lesson 7 speaks to.

How Chinese media frame Islam. A 2018 study (Luqiu and Yang, *Asian Journal of Communication*) found Chinese news coverage of Islam generally negative, with Muslims portrayed as prone to terrorism or as recipients of special treatment; a 2021 study of state media found global Islam framed as dangerous while domestic Muslim minorities are framed as "good minzu". Contact changes this: a small study of 200 young Chinese found more contact with Muslims meant fewer negative stereotypes. Your friendship is the correction.

Common lay images of Islam (from experience, not surveys): Islam equals not eating pork; 清真 is just a food label; Islam is "the Arabs' religion" or "Xinjiang's religion"; Muslims and terrorism; Muslim women are oppressed. The handbook's Chinese-questions section answers each.

The legal rules for foreigners

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p4.html#s04

This is a description of the published rules, not legal advice. Enforcement varies by city and by year.

Instrument	Issuer	In force	What it does
Provisions on the Administration of Religious Activities of Aliens within the PRC (境内外国人宗教活动管理规定)	State Council Decree 144	31 January 1994	Parent rule: foreigners may not set up religious organisations, open religious schools, or "develop followers among Chinese citizens"
Regulations on Religious Affairs (宗教事务条例), revised 2017	State Council	1 February 2018	General framework: religious activity at registered venues; religion not subject to foreign domination; online religious content needs a licence (2022 measures)
Detailed Rules for the Implementation of the Provisions on the Administration of Religious Activities of Foreigners (外国人在中华人民共和国境内宗教活动管理规定实施细则)	National Religious Affairs Administration Order 23	1 May 2025 (published 1 April 2025); 5 chapters, 38 articles	Replaces the 2000 implementation rules; mostly consolidates rules already in force

What a foreigner may do (2025 rules as reported):

- Attend services at legally registered mosques (and temples and churches). Article 4 says the state respects foreigners' freedom of religious belief.
- Hold collective religious activities for foreigners at a registered site or approved temporary venue, with Chinese clergy presiding; the organisers must name three or more conveners, each with a residence permit valid for more than six months.
- Give a sermon or lecture only on invitation through a national or provincial religious association, with the content submitted in advance (Article 20).
- Bring in religious books and media for personal use (reports say up to ten copies without prior permission; article not verified).

What a foreigner may not do:

- Preach or proselytise without authorisation (擅自传教).
- Recruit Chinese citizens as followers (在中国公民中发展教徒).
- Establish religious organisations, schools or training; produce, sell or distribute religious materials; accept religious donations.
- Organise collective religious activities outside approved venues, or have foreign clergy preside without approval.

- In serious cases the venue can be ordered to stop serving foreigners; fines and expulsion are reported in general terms.

What this means in practice for you: private friendship, answering questions people put to you, living your religion visibly and attending the mosque are the realistic path. Do not hand out booklets, do not post religious content for Chinese audiences on WeChat, Douyin or Bilibili, do not run a study circle for Chinese citizens, and do not discuss Xinjiang or politics. A Chinese friend who becomes interested can read Ma Jian's Quran, which is legally printed and sold inside China, and can go to the mosque and speak to the ahong himself.

Sources (located through search extracts, not opened; read the full text at China Law Translate when you can): China Law Translate, 2025 implementation rules; Shaanxi Normal University English text; CECC bilingual Regulations on Religious Affairs; 1994 Provisions (BFSU); China Christian Daily report, 3 April 2025; ADHRRF translation of key articles.

Confucian bridges and Chinese Islamic vocabulary



🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p4.html#s05

Bridges

Chinese idea	Where it comes from	Islamic counterpart	How to use it
天 Tian, Heaven; 天命 Mandate of Heaven	Confucius treats Heaven as a moral authority; Mencius 7A1: know your heart, know your nature, know Heaven	The Creator	"Confucius respected Heaven; we say Heaven has a Lord." The Han Kitab used 真主, not 天, to avoid an impersonal sky
敬鬼神而远之 (Analects 6.22)	Respect the spirits but keep them at a distance	Rejecting superstition while affirming the unseen	Islam also forbids fortune-telling and idol worship but affirms God and the unseen
己所不欲，勿施于人 (Analects 15.24)	The negative golden rule	Hadith: none of you believes until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself (Bukhari)	Quote both; the strongest bridge you have
良知 / 良心 (Mencius 7A15); the four sprouts (2A6)	Humans are born with hearts of compassion, shame, respect and right-and-wrong	Fitrah (30:30); the hadith that every child is born on the fitrah	A 2025 comparative study (San Jose State, *Comparative Philosophy*) finds Wang Yangming's liangzhi and fitrah both posit an inborn moral faculty and both reject original depravity
人之初，性本善 (Three Character Classic)	People are born good	No original sin	"Islam agrees with Mencius, not with Xunzi"
诚 cheng, sincerity (Zhongyong)	"The Way of all Ways", linking the Way of man and the Way of Heaven	Ikhlas, sidq; Wang Daiyu's definition of 真 as 诚一不二	
孝 xiao, filial piety	Core Confucian virtue	Quran 17:23-24; 忠主孝亲	Islam honours parents and visits graves, but prays only to God

Chinese idea	Where it comes from	Islamic counterpart	How to use it
中庸 zhongyong, the middle way	Confucian ideal of moderation	Ummatan wasatan, “a middle nation” (2:143)	
礼 li, ritual propriety	Order of society and self	Salah, the five pillars	Liu Zhi's chosen common ground

Standard Chinese Islamic vocabulary

The forms used by Hui Muslims and in Ma Jian's Quran. Hui speech mixes Arabic and Persian loanwords with Chinese; most dictionaries omit them, so learn them from the mosque.

Concept	Chinese	Note
Allah	真主 (standard), 安拉 (media), 真宰 (classical)	
Islam / Muslim	伊斯兰教 / 穆斯林; older 回教, 清真教	回教 now avoided
Tawhid	认主独一	
Shahada	清真言 (万物非主，唯有真主；穆罕默德是真主的使者), also 作证言	
Five pillars	五功: 念 礼 斋 课 朝	礼拜/拜功, 封斋/斋戒, 天课, 朝觐
Convert	归信（伊斯兰）; colloquial 入教	
This life / hereafter	今世 / 后世	
Paradise / hell	天堂 or 乐园 / 火狱	
Messenger / prophet / the Prophet	使者 / 先知 / 穆圣	
Hadith / sunnah	圣训 / 圣行	
Imam (title) / mosque cleric	伊玛目 / 阿訇 (ahong, from Persian akhund)	阿訇 is the everyday word
Mosque / Quran	清真寺 / 古兰经	
Halal (food) / lawful (fiqh)	清真 / 合法	
Dua / intention	杜阿（祈祷）/ 举意	
Angel / Satan	天神 or 天使 / 恶魔	Ma Jian uses 天神
Shirk	以物配主	
Qadar	前定	

Chinese-language dawah resources

🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/p4.html#s06

Access inside China was not tested; assume foreign sites need a VPN and that you may not distribute material to Chinese citizens (see the legal section). These are for your own study and for a friend who asks.

Resource	What it is	Access
《走进伊斯兰》 A Brief Illustrated Guide to Understanding	The classic 74-page booklet for non-Muslims, translated by Ismael Hasan;	Saudi-hosted; access in China

Resource	What it is	Access
Islam, Chinese edition (IslamHouse)	contains the Quran-and-science chapter	unknown
IslamHouse Chinese section	Books, articles and videos in Chinese, including Bilal Philips's *The True Religion*	Same
QuranEnc Chinese translations	Several Chinese translations side by side	Same
Quran.com with Ma Jian's translation	Arabic with Chinese and audio	Google-dependent assets may fail in China
Islamic Association of China	Official, legal; publishes the journal 《中国穆斯林》	Accessible in China; safest source
Ma Jian Quran, printed	Sold at major mosques (Niujie, Xi'an, Guangzhou) and Muslim bookshops	Legal inside China
Chinese Quran apps on the Chinese App Store	古兰经 中文音频朗诵、翻译和解释; 穆斯林和古兰经专业版 (prayer times, hadith); 古兰经 简明注释	Listed on the China App Store
Hui Muslim websites	Many older portals (中穆网, 伊斯兰之光) have been closed or censored; check current status	Variable
Bilibili / Douyin	No reliable Chinese Muslim channels were found; religious content needs a licence under the 2022 online rules	Do not post

Warning: islam.cn is an Ahmadiyya site with its own Quran translation, not mainstream Sunni. Check who runs any Chinese Islamic site before you recommend it.

The best resource is a person. The ahong at your local mosque has answered every Chinese question a hundred times, in Chinese. Ask to sit with him weekly; bring the handbook and let him correct the Chinese.

Sources

Located and quoted through search extracts on 27 October 2026; not opened in full. Verify before citing.

History

- Islam during the Tang dynasty (Wikipedia)
- History of Islam in China (Wikipedia)
- HKU project on Chinese Muslim origin narratives and Guangzhou's Islamic heritage
- Great Mosque of Xi'an (Wikipedia)
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Appendix B: Bibliography and Indexes

The consolidated reference section of the book: every source in one place, plus indexes so you can find any verse, hadith or question quickly.

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🔊 **Listen to this section:** https://israfil-hossen.github.io/hsk-vocab/dawah/pb.html#s01

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Index of Quran verses

Locations: I.3 = Part I, Chapter 3; II.2 = Part II, section 2; III.A1 = Part III, objection A1; V.L3 = Part V, Lesson 3.

Verse	Topic	Where
2:3	Belief in the unseen	I.3 Q5
2:23; 10:38; 11:13; 17:88	The Quran's challenge	I.4.4; II.5; III.E6
2:106; 16:101	Abrogation	III.E3
2:155-157	Life as a test	III.B1
2:164	Signs in creation	III.A8; III.D1
2:170	Against blind imitation	III.A8; III.A11
2:173; 5:3	Pork and forbidden foods	I.5.2; V.L9
2:186; 40:60	Prayer is answered	III.B7
2:190; 22:39-40	Fighting only in defence	I.5.4; III.F4
2:255	Who God is	I.6
2:256	No compulsion in religion	I.3 Q7; I.5.4; I.6; I.8.1; III.F3
3:190-191	Reflection on creation	I.2.3; I.6
4:4; 4:7	Women's dower and inheritance	I.5.3
4:40	Proportionate justice	III.B9
4:56	Skin and pain	II.2 (31)
4:82	No contradiction	III.B5; III.E2
5:8	Justice toward enemies	I.3 Q7; I.5.4
5:32	One life like all mankind	I.3 Q7; I.5.4; I.6; III.F4

Verse	Topic	Where
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6:38	Animal communities	II.2 (41); III.B3
7:157; 29:48	The unlettered Prophet	I.4.4; III.E5-E6
10:5; 71:15-16	Moon's light reflected	I.4.3; II.2 (6)
10:22; 29:65	Calling on God in danger	I.2.6
10:101	Observe the heavens and earth	I.6
13:28	Hearts find rest	I.3 Q16; I.6; V.L7
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15:9	Preservation of the Quran	I.4.2; II.4
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16:125	The method of dawah	I.1.3; I.6
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17:36	Do not follow what you do not know	III.A8
17:85	The soul	I.2.5; III.A14
18:29	Whoever wills, believe	I.3 Q14; III.B8
21:30	Heavens and earth joined; life from water	I.3 Q4; I.4.3; I.6; II.2 (1, 36)
21:33; 36:40	Orbits	I.4.3; II.2 (5)
21:107; 49:13	Islam for all humanity	I.5.1; I.6
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24:30-31	Lowering the gaze; hijab	I.5.3; III.F1
24:40	Deep-sea darkness	I.4.3; II.2 (20)
24:43	Clouds, rain, hail	I.4.3; II.2 (21)
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35:15	God is free of need	I.3 Q12
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96:1	“Read”	I.3 Q2; III.D1
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None of you believes until he loves for his brother…	Sahih al-Bukhari 13; Sahih Muslim 45	Sahih	I.6.2; IV.5
Make things easy, do not make them difficult	Sahih al-Bukhari 69; Sahih Muslim 1734	Sahih	I.8.4
Every child is born upon the fitrah	Sahih al-Bukhari 1385; Sahih Muslim 2658	Sahih	I.2.6; I.6.2
Armour mortgaged for barley	Sahih al-Bukhari 2916	Sahih	I.4.6; II.7
End of Khosrau and Caesar	Sahih al-Bukhari 3120-3121; Sahih Muslim 2918	Sahih	I.4.5; II.6
My mercy prevails over My wrath	Sahih al-Bukhari 3194; Sahih Muslim 2751	Sahih	I.3 Q13; I.6.2
Consent to marriage	Sahih al-Bukhari 5136	Sahih	I.5.3
Hardship expiates sins	Sahih al-Bukhari 5641-5642; Sahih Muslim 2573	Sahih	I.3 Q6
The strong man controls himself when angry	Sahih al-Bukhari 6114; Sahih Muslim 2609	Sahih	I.6.2; I.8.6
No fire lit in the Prophet's house for months	Sahih al-Bukhari 6458-6459	Sahih	II.7
The Euphrates will uncover gold	Sahih al-Bukhari 7119; Sahih Muslim 2894	Sahih	II.6
The earth was folded for me, east and west	Sahih Muslim 2889	Sahih	I.4.5; II.6
Smiling is charity	Jami' al-Tirmidhi 1956	Hasan	I.6.2
Best of you are best to their families	Jami' al-Tirmidhi 3895	Sahih	I.5.3; I.6.2
Abu Bakr's wager on Rome	Jami' al-Tirmidhi 3193-3194	Check grading	II.6
Paradise is beneath her feet	Sunan al-Nasa'i 3104	Hasan	I.5.3; I.6.2

Hadith	Source	Grade	Where
I was sent to perfect good character	al-Adab al-Mufrad 273; Musnad Ahmad 8952	Sahih	I.6.2; I.8.6
Abu Bakr's instructions to the army	Muwatta Malik, Book of Jihad	Athar (report of a Companion)	I.5.4
Constantinople will be conquered	Musnad Ahmad; al-Hakim, *Mustadrak* 4:422	Contested	II.6
Suraqa and Khosrau's bracelets	al-Bayhaqi, *Dala'il al-Nubuwwa*	Mursal (weak chain)	II.6
“Seek knowledge even in China”	Various	Very weak; do not attribute	I.6.3

Index of questions

Every question answered in the book. Start with the short answer in Part I; go to Part III for depth.

Question	Short answer	In depth
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Why not an infinite chain of causes?	I.3 Q1	III.A2
Didn't the universe come from nothing?	I.3 Q4	III.A3
Doesn't a multiverse explain fine-tuning?	I.2.2	III.A4
Isn't God just filling gaps in science?	I.3 Q2	III.A5
Isn't the burden of proof on believers?	I.2.6	III.A6
Don't extraordinary claims need extraordinary evidence?	I.3 Q15	III.A7
Isn't faith blind?	I.4.7	III.A8
Isn't religion an evolutionary by-product?	I.2.6	III.A9
Isn't religion the opium of the people?	I.3 Q11	III.A10
Don't you only believe because of where you were born?	I.3 Q10	III.A11
Can't I be good without God?	I.3 Q8	III.A12
Is it good because God commands it? (Euthyphro)	I.2.4	III.A13
Isn't consciousness just the brain?	I.2.5	III.A14
Why is there suffering?	I.3 Q6	III.B1
Why natural disasters? Why do animals suffer?	I.3 Q6	III.B2-B3
Why doesn't God show Himself?	I.3 Q5	III.B4-B5
Aren't miracles impossible?	I.3 Q15	III.B6
Why doesn't prayer work?	—	III.B7
If God knows everything, are we free?	I.3 Q14	III.B8
How can a loving God send people to	I.3 Q13	III.B9

Question	Short answer	In depth
hell?		
What about people who never heard of Islam?	I.3 Q13	III.B10
Why does God need worship?	I.3 Q12	III.C1
Isn't God's anger petty?	—	III.C2
Doesn't science replace religion?	I.3 Q2	III.D1
Doesn't evolution disprove God or Adam?	I.3 Q3	III.D2
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Is the Quran really preserved?	I.4.2	II.4; III.E1
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There are thousands of religions; which is true?	I.3 Q9	III.A11
Doesn't religion cause war?	I.3 Q7	III.F5
Isn't Islam violent?	I.5.4	III.F4
Doesn't Islam oppress women? Why the hijab?	I.5.3	III.F1
What about slavery, apostasy, Aisha's age?	—	III.F2, F3, F6
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Why no pork?	I.5.2	V.L9
Why pray five times a day?	I.5.5	V.L9
Does Islam respect parents and ancestors?	I.5.6	IV.5; V.L10
How is Islam different from Buddhism?	I.5.7	V.L5
Can I believe in God without a religion?	I.5.8	—
What is the purpose of life?	I.3 Q16	V.L7
I want to become Muslim; what do I do?	I.8	—

Glossary of Arabic and Islamic terms



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Term	Meaning	中文
Ahl al-fatrah	People the message never clearly reached; excused (17:15)	未闻使者之人
Ahong	Persian-derived Chinese title for a mosque imam	阿訇
Alaqah	“Clinging thing”; the embryo's second stage (23:14)	一块结的血 / 水蛭状物
Allah	God, the One Creator	真主 / 安拉
Ayah	A verse of the Quran	节（经文）
Dawah	Inviting people to Islam	宣教
Da'if	A weak hadith	脆弱的圣训
Dua	Personal supplication	杜阿 / 祈祷
Fitrah	The innate nature God placed in every human, inclined to recognise Him	天性
Hadith	A report of the Prophet's words, actions or approvals	圣训
Hadith qudsi	A hadith in which the Prophet conveys God's words	神圣圣训
Hafiz (pl. huffaz)	One who has memorised the whole Quran	背诵全经者
Halal / haram	Permitted / forbidden	清真（合法）/ 禁止
Han Kitab	Islamic books written in Chinese, 17th-18th centuries	汉克塔布
Hasan	A good, acceptable hadith	良好的圣训
Hijab	Modest dress; the headscarf	头巾 / 盖头
Huiru	“Muslim Confucians”, the Han Kitab scholars	回儒
I'jaz	The inimitability of the Quran	《古兰经》的不可模仿性
Ijazah	A teaching licence with a chain back to the Prophet	传授许可
Iman	Faith; the six articles of belief	信仰 / 伊玛尼
Isnad	The chain of narrators of a hadith	传述系统
Jihad	Striving in God's way; includes self-discipline; armed only in defence under strict rules	奈力 / 圣战
Mawdu'	A fabricated hadith	伪造的圣训
Mudghah	“Chewed-like lump”; the embryo's third stage	一块肉
Mushaf	A written copy of the Quran	经本
Naskh	Abrogation: a later ruling replacing an earlier one	废止
Nutfah	A drop of fluid; the embryo's first stage	精液
Qadar	Divine decree; God's knowledge and power over all things	前定

Qira'at	The canonical readings of the Quran	诵读法
Rasm	The consonantal skeleton of the Quranic text	经文字形
Sahih	An authentic hadith	健全的圣训
Salah	The five daily prayers	礼拜 / 拜功
Sawm	Fasting	封斋
Shahada	The testimony of faith	清真言 / 作证言
Shirk	Associating partners with God	以物配主
Sirah	The biography of the Prophet	先知传记
Sunnah	The Prophet's way and practice	圣行
Surah	A chapter of the Quran	章
Tafsir	Commentary on the Quran	经注
Tawhid	The oneness of God	认主独一
Ummah	The Muslim community	穆斯林社会 / 乌玛
Wudu	Ablution before prayer	小净
Zakat	Obligatory charity	天课

Note: for “angels”, Hui tradition says 天仙 (as in 六信, the six articles), Ma Jian's Quran uses 天神, and general Chinese uses 天使. All three are understood. Some Chinese renderings in this glossary are descriptive; ask your ahong for the term used at your mosque.

Pre-publication checklist

The book is complete in structure and content. Before you print it or teach from it, do these checks. Tick them off here as you go.

Religious content

- ☐ Ask a qualified scholar (or your local ahong) to read Part I and Chapter 8 in particular.
- ☐ Check every Chinese verse marked * in Part I, Chapter 6 against a printed Ma Jian Quran.
- ☐ Check every hadith number and grade in the hadith index at sunnah.com.
- ☐ Confirm the grading of Tirmidhi 3193-3194 (Abu Bakr's wager) and the Constantinople hadith before using them.

Facts and sources

- ☐ Open each link in the bibliography and confirm the wording quoted; the research could read only search extracts.
- ☐ Check the items marked Unverified in Part II (Gibb's “deep-toned instrument”, Arberry's preface, Besant, Lamartine's French original).
- ☐ Read the full text of NRAA Order No. 23 (2025) at China Law Translate and update Part I, Chapter 1 and Part IV, section 4 if anything differs.
- ☐ Read Zakir Naik's *Answers to Non-Muslims' Common Questions* and add his answers to Part III, F7.

Chinese language

- ☐ Have a native Chinese speaker correct every Chinese line in Part I and the dialogues in Part V.
- ☐ Record the one-minute message and the twelve dialogues with a native speaker for listening practice.

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